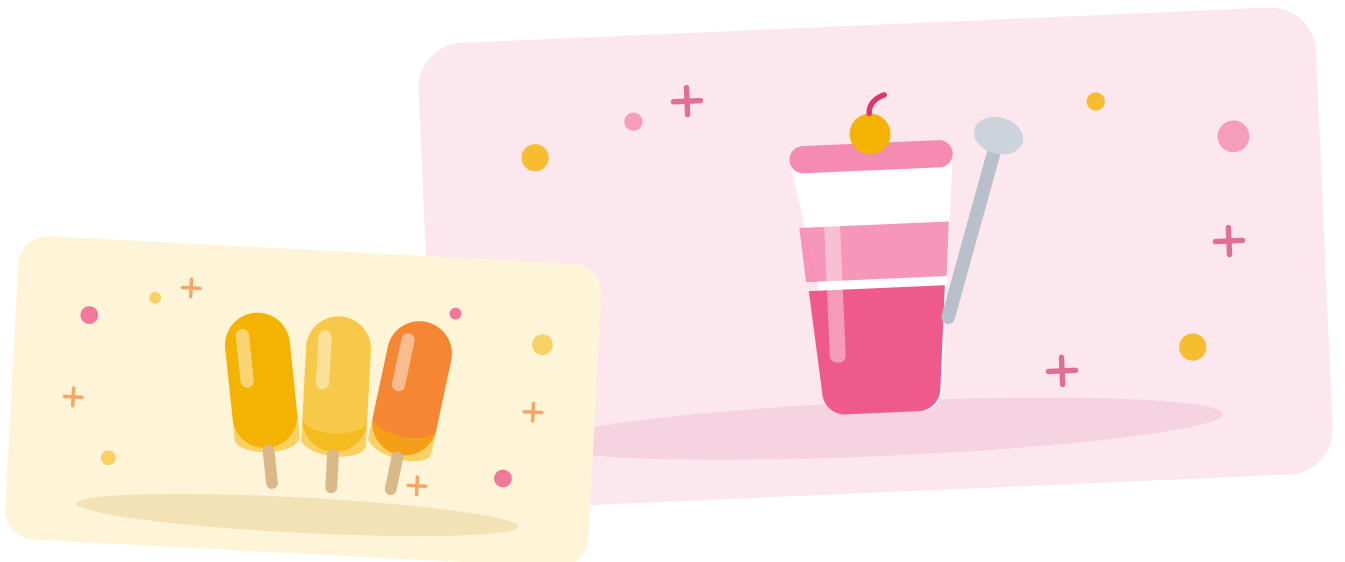


The Family Dessert Kitchen

A Playful Guide to Cooking, Tasting & Learning Together

Thirty-two family desserts, safety missions, a Flavor Lab, and a Nutrition Explorer — for children about 5–12 and the adults who cook with them.



BY

Cristy Sim

DEVELOPMENT RECIPE — REQUIRES KITCHEN TESTING

ABOUT THIS COMPANION

An independent companion book

This is a standalone companion to the Body Recomp Bible editorial world. **It is not one of the five canonical Body Recomp Bible volumes.** It borrows the calm, practical, non-shaming voice and the minimal visual system of *The Recomp Kitchen* — white pages, charcoal type, one clear blue accent — then adds a playful register for young cooks.



The kitchen rule

Dessert does not need to dress up as medicine. It can offer flavor, connection, and kitchen practice. No food is a reward, and no child has to earn something sweet.

Who it is for

Families with children about **5–12** and their adult caregivers. Adults stay responsible for heat, knives, appliances, allergens, food safety, and age-appropriate textures.

Who needs extra guidance

Children under 5, and any child with swallowing, developmental, allergy, or medical needs, require individualized adult and professional guidance. This book does not replace it.

Development status — please read

Every recipe here is a development draft. Recipes have **not** been kitchen-tested, and this book publishes no calories, macros, verified yields, or shelf-life. Before anything here could be called final it must pass: kitchen testing · sensory testing · standardized ingredient weights · verified yield · allergen review · food-safety review · storage validation · pediatric or qualified nutrition review · and Cristy Sim's final approval.

Nothing in this book is described as final, tested, approved, or publication-ready.

The Family Dessert Kitchen

Cristy Sim · Development Edition

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What is inside

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SECTION 1

Welcome to the Family Dessert Kitchen

This book starts with a simple idea: **dessert can be a pleasant, predictable part of family life.** There is no need to hide ingredients, turn every recipe into a nutrition promise, or ask a child to earn something sweet. The recipes use familiar ingredients and small, real tasks so children can genuinely take part — while an adult stays in charge of the parts that need care.



For the young cook

- You are a real cook here, not a helper.
- You get to notice, measure, mix, taste, and invent.
- You never have to finish a food or love every flavor.
- Saying “I am done” or “not yet” is allowed.



For the adult

- You handle heat, knives, appliances, and allergens.
- You choose safe sizes and textures for your child.
- You keep the mood calm — no bargaining over bites.
- You decide what fits your family and your kitchen.



How this book teaches

Every recipe carries a small **learning activity** — a thing to notice, compare, count, or smell. The goal is curiosity and skill, never pressure to eat. Alongside the recipes you will find a Flavor Lab, a Nutrition Explorer, kitchen games, and a testing journal, all built around the same idea: **cooking is a wonderful way to learn.**

A note on words we do not use

You will not see foods called clean, dirty, good, bad, guilt-free, or sinful. Food gives the body energy and building blocks; it is not a moral test. We describe flavor and texture instead — creamy, tart, warm, crunchy — because those are the words that help a young cook grow.

SECTION 2

How to Use This Book

Each recipe page follows the same shape, so once you learn one, you know them all. Here is what every panel means.

① Header & status

The recipe number, chapter, title, an estimated yield, and an estimated time. A dark **Development Recipe** stamp is a promise that this formula still needs testing.

② What you need

Ingredients in US measures with an estimated metric next to each. Metric weights are approximate until we weigh every ingredient during testing.

③ Make it

Numbered steps in order. Read them together before you start and gather everything first.

④ Roles

The Child Can (mango) and **The Adult Handles** (blue) split the job so everyone is safe and busy.

⑤ Flavor, allergens & age

A flavor-and-texture note, **allergens to check**, and age & texture guidance. Always read labels yourself.

⑥ Learn, swap & test

One learning activity, one optional substitution, and a **Test Still Needed** note listing what must be checked before publication.



Writing in this book

Wherever you see a **line** or a **box**, you may write, tick, or draw. In a PDF reader many of these are fillable on screen; on paper, use a pencil. Adults can reset a printed page by printing a fresh copy.

Symbols you will meet



Child Can

A task made for young hands.



Adult Handles

Heat, blades, appliances, doneness.



Learn

Something to notice or try.



Mission

A Dessert Detectives challenge.

Read this before every recipe

- An adult stays with young cooks the whole time.
- Wash hands before you start and after touching raw egg.
- Recipes with egg must be cooked all the way through.
- Cut round or hard foods small; let hot and frozen foods reach a safe temperature.
- If an allergy is diagnosed, follow your healthcare professional's plan.

A quick family agreement

Fill this in together before you cook for the first time.

Our grown-up helper today is _____ and our young cook is _____.

We agree that:

- ☐ hands get washed first ☐ the adult does the hot and sharp jobs
☐ no one has to finish a food ☐ we describe flavors instead of judging them

SECTION 3 • FOR THE ADULT

Adult Safety Guide

Children can do a great deal in the kitchen when the risky parts are clearly an adult's job. This guide is written for you, the caregiver. Read it once before you begin, and keep the calm, matter-of-fact tone the recipes use — safety works best without fear.



Supervision & hygiene

- Stay within arm's reach of young cooks the whole time.
- Everyone washes hands with soap and warm water before cooking, after handling raw egg, and after using the bathroom or touching pets.
- Tie back hair, roll up sleeves, and wipe surfaces before you start.
- Keep raw egg away from foods that will not be cooked.



Heat & burn prevention

- The adult manages the oven, stove, and anything hot.
- Turn pot handles inward; use dry oven mitts.
- Let baked and warm desserts cool from hot to warm before a child tastes them.
- Baked fruit and its juices hold heat — cool well and check before serving.



Knives, blenders & appliances

- The adult does all cutting and runs blenders and food processors.
- Unplug appliances before scraping the jar; keep fingers away from blades.
- Give children safe tools instead: spoons, whisks, cups, mashers, and clean hands.



Perishables & doneness

- Keep yogurt, milk, and egg mixtures cold until use; do not leave them out on the counter.
- Cook every egg-containing recipe fully — no wet or runny centers.
- Serve freshly; this draft does not provide validated storage times.

If you remember only one thing

You decide what is safe for *your* child today — the right size, the right texture, the right amount of help. When in doubt, make the piece smaller, the task simpler, and the supervision closer.

Choking, texture & age

Match every piece and consistency to your child's skills. The foods below are common choking hazards for young children and need adult judgment — cut small, modify the texture, or leave out.

Cut, modify, or skip for the young

- Whole or round fruit — quarter grapes and berries lengthwise.
- Whole nuts and hard, dense pieces.
- Thick, sticky spoonfuls of nut or seed butter — spread thin.
- Large chunks of dried fruit such as raisins — chop or omit for the very young.
- Hard, still-frozen pieces — let soften first.

Build safer textures

- Blend, mash, or finely chop to suit the child.
- Thin nut or seed butter with yogurt or milk.
- Serve pops and bark once slightly softened.
- Offer water alongside; children eat seated and calm, never while walking or playing.



Allergens: name them, do not guess

Read **every label, every time**. A substitution changes flavor, structure, **and** the allergen profile. Recipes list allergens to check, but brands vary — the label is the authority. Common allergens to watch in this book include milk, egg, wheat (via oats with cross-contact), tree nuts, peanuts, soy, and seeds.

If your child has a **diagnosed** allergy, follow the plan from your family's healthcare professional. This book cannot replace that plan.

Oats & cross-contact

Oats are naturally wheat-free but are often processed near wheat. If wheat is a concern, choose oats labeled to address cross-contact and confirm on the package.

Warm-up mission: Safe-Tool Sort

Do this together before your first recipe. For each tool, tick who should use it. Then check your answers against the guide above.

Hint: anything hot, sharp, or electric is an adult tool.



Spoon

Who uses it? ☐ Child ☐ Adult



Whisk

Who uses it? ☐ Child ☐ Adult



Measuring cups

Who uses it? ☐ Child ☐ Adult



Mixing bowl

Who uses it? ☐ Child ☐ Adult



Sharp knife

Who uses it? ☐ Child ☐ Adult



Blender

Who uses it? ☐ Child ☐ Adult



Hot oven

Who uses it? ☐ Child ☐ Adult



Stovetop

Who uses it? ☐ Child ☐ Adult

Talk about it

Ask your child: "What could go wrong if this were a child's job? What safe tool could we use instead?" The answers below become second nature with practice.

Child tools: spoon, whisk, measuring cups, mixing bowl. **Adult tools:** sharp knife, blender, hot oven, stovetop.

SECTION 4

Meet the Dessert Detectives

A Dessert Detective is a young cook who **notices things**. Detectives do not judge food as good or bad — they investigate flavor, texture, aroma, color, and safety. Throughout this book you will find numbered **missions**. Some are quick questions; some ask you to draw, measure, or invent.

There are no rewards for eating and no punishments for leaving food. The reward is learning something together.



Detective Badge

The Detective Code

- I wash my hands first.
- I notice before I decide.
- I use kind, curious words.

My Detective Powers

- Looking closely
- Smelling carefully
- Measuring exactly
- Describing clearly

My Superpower

Saying “I am done,” “I want to try,” or “not that texture yet” is real detective skill, too.



Become a Detective

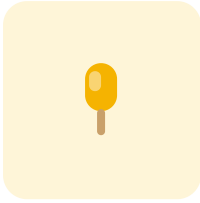
My detective name is _____ and today's date is _____.

I promise to investigate with curiosity and kindness. Signed: _____

Track your missions as you go — there are **fourteen** to collect:

☐	1	☐	2	☐	3	☐	4	☐	5	☐	6	☐	7	☐	8	☐	9	☐	10	☐	11
☐	12	☐	13	☐	14																

CHAPTER 5

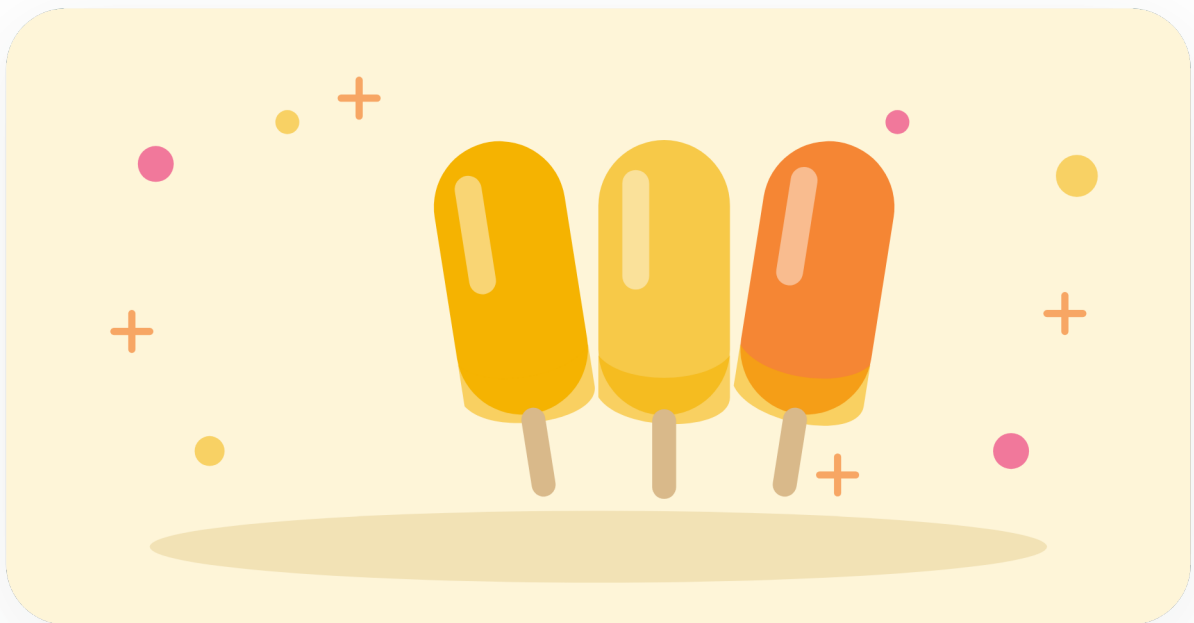


Frozen & Fruity

Cool it down. Blend, freeze, and scrape fruit into pops, bark, and creamy chills.

IN THIS CHAPTER

- | | | | |
|----|-------------------------------------|----|----------------------------------|
| 01 | Creamy Mango Yogurt Pops | 04 | Two-Ingredient Banana Nice-Cream |
| 02 | Blueberry Frozen-Yogurt Cereal Bark | 05 | Yogurt-Dipped Banana Coins |
| 03 | Watermelon-Mint Granita | | |



DEVELOPMENT RECIPE — REQUIRES KITCHEN TESTING

Every recipe here still requires kitchen testing.

RECIPE 01 · FROZEN & FRUITY

DEVELOPMENT RECIPE — REQUIRES KITCHEN TESTING



Creamy Mango Yogurt Pops

🕒 **Estimated time** 10 min + freezing · **Estimated yield** about 8 small pops (estimated)

Do not publish or assign nutrition values before testing flavor, cooking, yield, allergens, and storage.

WHAT YOU NEED

- 2 cups frozen mango chunks (~300 g)
- 1 cup plain yogurt (~245 g)
- 1 tsp vanilla (5 ml)
- 1–2 Tbsp water, only if needed (15–30 ml)

MAKE IT

- 01 Blend the mango, yogurt, and vanilla until smooth, adding water only if the blender needs help.
- 02 Divide among pop molds, add sticks, and freeze until firm.

**THE CHILD CAN**

Measure the yogurt and fill the molds with a small ladle.

**THE ADULT HANDLES**

Runs the blender, places the sticks, and manages the freezer.

Flavor & texture

Cool, thick, and creamy with a bright mango tang.

Allergens to check

Milk. Use a plain unsweetened dairy-free yogurt if that already fits the child's diet.

Age & texture

Let pops soften 1–2 minutes so they are easy to bite. Adult decides the safe size for the child.

**Learn together**

Colour Watch: notice how the orange mango and white yogurt swirl into one shade. Guess the new colour before blending.

Try a swap: Swap mango for frozen peaches or pineapple.

Test still needed: Test sweetness, how easily the pops unmold, and the real number of pops.

**We made this!**

One thing we noticed: _____



RECIPE 02 · FROZEN & FRUITY

DEVELOPMENT RECIPE — REQUIRES KITCHEN TESTING



Blueberry Frozen-Yogurt Cereal Bark

🕒 **Estimated time** 10 min + freezing · **Estimated yield** about 8 pieces (estimated)

Do not publish or assign nutrition values before testing flavor, cooking, yield, allergens, and storage.

WHAT YOU NEED

- 2 cups plain yogurt (~490 g)
- 1 cup blueberries, halved or lightly mashed (~150 g)
- 1/2 cup crunchy oat cereal (~30 g)
- 1/2 tsp vanilla (2.5 ml)

MAKE IT

- 01 Stir the vanilla into the yogurt and spread it about 1 cm thick on a lined tray.
- 02 Scatter the blueberries and cereal on top, then freeze until firm and break into age-appropriate pieces.

**THE CHILD CAN**

Spread the yogurt with the back of a spoon and arrange the fruit in a pattern.

**THE ADULT HANDLES**

Halves the blueberries, manages the freezer, and breaks the bark into safe sizes.

Flavor & texture

Crackly, cold, and lightly sweet with pops of berry.

Allergens to check

Milk; cereal may contain wheat or other allergens — read the box.

Age & texture

Halved berries reduce choking risk. Break bark small; hard frozen edges need a moment to soften.

**Learn together**

Pattern Lab: make stripes, spots, or a smiley. Which pattern is easiest to break evenly?

Try a swap: Use raspberries or chopped strawberries instead of blueberries.

Test still needed: Validate spread thickness, thaw time, and how easily children can bite a piece.

**We made this!**

One thing we noticed: _____



RECIPE 03 · FROZEN & FRUITY

DEVELOPMENT RECIPE — REQUIRES KITCHEN TESTING



Watermelon-Mint Granita

🕒 **Estimated time** 15 min + freezing (stir every 30 min) · **Estimated yield** about 4 small cups (estimated)

Do not publish or assign nutrition values before testing flavor, cooking, yield, allergens, and storage.

WHAT YOU NEED

- 4 cups seedless watermelon cubes (~600 g)
- 1 tsp lime juice (5 ml)
- 4–6 small mint leaves (a few)
- 1 tsp honey, optional* (5 ml)

MAKE IT

- 01 Blend the watermelon, lime, and mint until smooth, then pour into a shallow dish.
- 02 Freeze, and every 30 minutes scrape with a fork to make icy flakes, until fully frozen and fluffy.



THE CHILD CAN

Scrape the freezing mixture with a fork to build the icy flakes.



THE ADULT HANDLES

Blends, handles the freezer, and cuts any large watermelon pieces first.

Flavor & texture

Light, refreshing, and slushy with a whisper of mint.

Allergens to check

None expected in the base — always confirm each label.

Age & texture

*Honey is not for children under 12 months. Serve small, soft flakes.



Learn together

Texture Timeline: draw the mixture at 0, 1, and 2 hours. How does liquid become flakes?

Try a swap: Swap watermelon for cantaloupe or strawberries.

Test still needed: Confirm scrape timing, flake texture, and final flavour balance.



We made this!

One thing we noticed: _____



RECIPE 04 · FROZEN & FRUITY

DEVELOPMENT RECIPE — REQUIRES KITCHEN TESTING



Two-Ingredient Banana Nice- Cream

🕒 **Estimated time** 5 min + freezing bananas ahead · **Estimated yield** about 4 small servings (estimated)

Do not publish or assign nutrition values before testing flavor, cooking, yield, allergens, and storage.

WHAT YOU NEED

- 3 ripe bananas, sliced and frozen (~330 g)
- 2–3 Tbsp milk of choice (30–45 ml)
- 1/4 tsp vanilla, optional (1 ml)

MAKE IT

- 01 Blend the frozen banana slices with a splash of milk, scraping down as needed.
- 02 Blend until it turns thick and creamy like soft ice cream; serve right away or freeze briefly to firm.

**THE CHILD CAN**

Add the banana slices and count the tablespoons of milk.

**THE ADULT HANDLES**

Runs the blender or food processor and checks the final texture.

Flavor & texture

Sweet, smooth, and soft-serve creamy — all from fruit.

Allergens to check

Milk if using dairy; choose a familiar dairy-free milk if preferred.

Age & texture

Serve soft. Freeze bananas fully ahead so the blend is smooth, not chunky.

**Learn together**

Change Watch: notice how hard frozen banana becomes creamy. What made it change?

Try a swap: Add a spoon of cocoa or a few berries for a new flavour.

Test still needed: Test milk amount for smoothness and the best serving temperature.

**We made this!**

One thing we noticed: _____



RECIPE 05 · FROZEN & FRUITY

DEVELOPMENT RECIPE — REQUIRES KITCHEN TESTING



Yogurt-Dipped Banana Coins

🕒 **Estimated time** 10 min + freezing · **Estimated yield** about 20 coins (estimated)

Do not publish or assign nutrition values before testing flavor, cooking, yield, allergens, and storage.

WHAT YOU NEED

- 2 bananas, sliced into coins (~220 g)
- 3/4 cup plain yogurt (~185 g)
- 1/2 tsp vanilla (2.5 ml)
- 2 Tbsp crushed oat cereal, optional (~10 g)

MAKE IT

- 01 Stir vanilla into the yogurt. Dip each banana coin to coat and set on a lined tray.
- 02 Sprinkle with cereal if you like, then freeze until firm.

**THE CHILD CAN**

Dip the coins with a fork and sprinkle the topping.

**THE ADULT HANDLES**

Slices the bananas to a safe thickness and manages the freezer.

Flavor & texture

Creamy-frozen outside, soft banana inside.

Allergens to check

Milk; cereal may contain wheat or other allergens.

Age & texture

Cut coins to a size and thickness suitable for the child; let soften slightly before eating.

**Learn together**

Count & Estimate: guess how many coins you can make, then count. Were you close?

Try a swap: Roll in finely crushed freeze-dried strawberries instead of cereal.

Test still needed: Confirm coin thickness, coating that stays on, and easy biting.



We made this!

One thing we noticed: _____



CHAPTER 6



Yogurt, Pudding & Creamy Cups

Spoonable and smooth. Yogurt, chia, and blended creams in little cups.

IN THIS CHAPTER

- 06 Strawberry Cheesecake Cups
- 07 Smooth Cocoa Chia Pudding
- 08 Chilled Cocoa-Avocado Cream
- 09 Peach-Vanilla Yogurt Parfait

- 10 Golden Mango-Coconut Pudding (Dairy-Free option)
- 29 Cocoa-Banana Smoothie Cups
- 30 Vanilla Rice Pudding Cups



DEVELOPMENT RECIPE — REQUIRES KITCHEN TESTING

Every recipe here still requires kitchen testing.

RECIPE 06 · YOGURT, PUDDING & CREAMY CUPS

DEVELOPMENT RECIPE — REQUIRES KITCHEN TESTING



Strawberry Cheesecake Cups

🕒 **Estimated time** 15 min · **Estimated yield** about 4 small cups (estimated)

Do not publish or assign nutrition values before testing flavor, cooking, yield, allergens, and storage.

WHAT YOU NEED

- 1 1/2 cups thick plain yogurt (~370 g)
- 1 cup chopped strawberries (~150 g)
- 4 graham crackers, crushed (~60 g)
- 1/2 tsp vanilla (2.5 ml)

MAKE IT

- 01 Stir the vanilla into the yogurt.
- 02 Layer yogurt and strawberries in small cups; add the crumbs just before serving so they stay crunchy.



THE CHILD CAN

Build the layers and choose the order.



THE ADULT HANDLES

Chops the strawberries small and checks every label.

Flavor & texture

Cool and creamy with a soft crunch and berry sweetness.

Allergens to check

Milk and wheat; exact allergens vary by cracker brand.

Age & texture

Chop strawberries small. Add crumbs at serving so texture stays easy.



Learn together

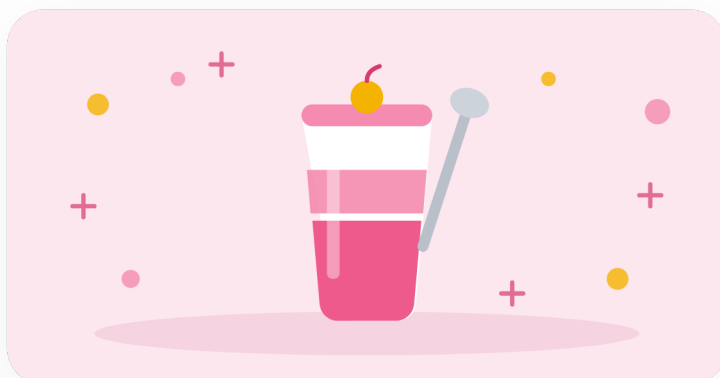
Layer Map: draw your cup from bottom to top. Which layer is thickest?

Try a swap: Use crushed plain oat cereal instead of graham crackers for a wheat swap to verify.

Test still needed: Validate cup size, layer texture, and the right amount of crumb.

☐ **We made this!**

One thing we noticed: _____



RECIPE 07 · YOGURT, PUDDING & CREAMY CUPS

DEVELOPMENT RECIPE — REQUIRES KITCHEN TESTING



Smooth Cocoa Chia Pudding

🕒 **Estimated time** 10 min + 2 hours chilling · **Estimated yield** about 4 small servings (estimated)

Do not publish or assign nutrition values before testing flavor, cooking, yield, allergens, and storage.

WHAT YOU NEED

- 1/4 cup chia seeds (~40 g)
- 1 cup milk of choice (240 ml)
- 2 Tbsp unsweetened cocoa (~12 g)
- 1 ripe banana (~110 g)
- 1/2 tsp vanilla (2.5 ml)

MAKE IT

- 01 Blend all ingredients until the chia is fully broken down and smooth.
- 02 Chill at least 2 hours, then stir and check the texture before serving.



THE CHILD CAN

Add ingredients with measuring cups and spoons.



THE ADULT HANDLES

Runs the blender and decides if the texture suits the child.

Flavor & texture

Silky, chocolatey, and gently sweet from banana.

Allergens to check

Milk depends on the drink chosen — check every label.

Age & texture

Blending smooths the chia. Confirm a texture the child manages comfortably.



Learn together

Thickness Test: check at 10 minutes and 2 hours. Draw how the spoon stands up.

Try a swap: Use any familiar milk; oat or soy milk both work.

Test still needed: Test thickness, texture acceptance, and the final portion size.



We made this!

One thing we noticed: _____



RECIPE 08 · YOGURT, PUDDING & CREAMY CUPS

DEVELOPMENT RECIPE — REQUIRES KITCHEN TESTING



Chilled Cocoa-Avocado Cream

🕒 **Estimated time** 10 min + 30 min chilling · **Estimated yield** about 4 small servings (estimated)

Do not publish or assign nutrition values before testing flavor, cooking, yield, allergens, and storage.

WHAT YOU NEED

- 2 ripe avocados (~250 g flesh)
- 1 ripe banana (~110 g)
- 3 Tbsp unsweetened cocoa (~18 g)
- 1/3 cup milk of choice (80 ml)
- 1 tsp vanilla (5 ml)

MAKE IT

- 01 Blend everything until completely smooth, scraping the sides as needed.
- 02 Chill 30 minutes and serve in small portions.



THE CHILD CAN

Scoop the avocado flesh with a spoon and count the measures.



THE ADULT HANDLES

Halves the avocados, removes the pits, and runs the blender.

Flavor & texture

Rich, mousse-like, and deeply chocolatey.

Allergens to check

Milk depends on the drink chosen.

Age & texture

Blend fully smooth. Serve small portions; texture is soft and spoonable.



Learn together

Colour Surprise: guess the colour before and after adding cocoa. What happened to the green?

Try a swap: Swap banana for a very ripe pear for a different sweetness.

Test still needed: Evaluate colour, aftertaste, thickness, and serving size.



We made this!

One thing we noticed: _____



RECIPE 09 · YOGURT, PUDDING & CREAMY CUPS

DEVELOPMENT RECIPE — REQUIRES KITCHEN TESTING



Peach-Vanilla Yogurt Parfait

🕒 **Estimated time** 12 min · **Estimated yield** about 3 small cups (estimated)

Do not publish or assign nutrition values before testing flavor, cooking, yield, allergens, and storage.

WHAT YOU NEED

- 1 1/2 cups plain yogurt (~370 g)
- 1 cup soft chopped peaches (~160 g)
- 1/2 cup rolled oats, toasted and cooled (~45 g)
- 1/2 tsp vanilla (2.5 ml)

MAKE IT

- 01 Stir vanilla into the yogurt. Cool the toasted oats fully.
- 02 Layer yogurt, peaches, and oats in small cups and serve.



THE CHILD CAN

Spoon the layers and sprinkle the cooled oats.



THE ADULT HANDLES

Toasts and cools the oats and chops the peaches small.

Flavor & texture

Creamy, fruity, and lightly nutty from toasted oats.

Allergens to check

Milk; oats may have cross-contact with wheat.

Age & texture

Use soft ripe peaches chopped small; make sure oats are cool and not clumped.



Learn together

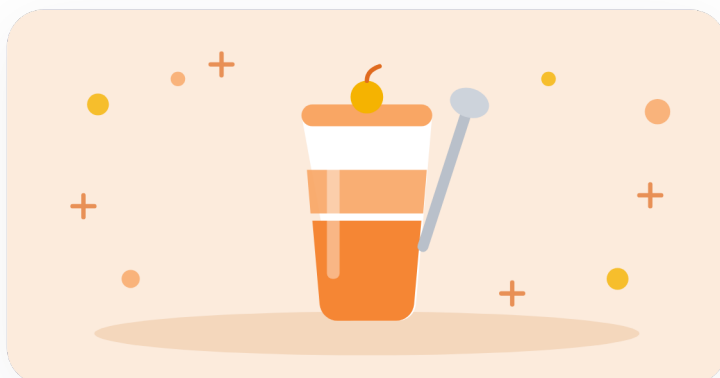
Smell First: sniff the peaches, then the vanilla. Which words describe each aroma?

Try a swap: Use canned peaches in juice (drained) when fresh are out of season.

Test still needed: Confirm oat toasting time, peach softness, and layer balance.

☐ **We made this!**

One thing we noticed: _____



RECIPE 10 · YOGURT, PUDDING & CREAMY CUPS

DEVELOPMENT RECIPE — REQUIRES KITCHEN TESTING



Golden Mango-Coconut Pudding (Dairy-Free option)

🕒 **Estimated time** 10 min + 1 hour chilling · **Estimated yield** about 4 small servings (estimated)

Do not publish or assign nutrition values before testing flavor, cooking, yield, allergens, and storage.

WHAT YOU NEED

- 2 cups frozen mango, thawed (~300 g)
- 3/4 cup coconut milk drink (180 ml)
- 2 Tbsp chia seeds (~20 g)
- 1/4 tsp vanilla (1 ml)

MAKE IT

- 01 Blend the mango and coconut milk until smooth, then stir in the chia seeds.
- 02 Chill at least 1 hour until set, stir, and serve in small cups.



THE CHILD CAN

Stir in the chia seeds and give it a taste-test smell.



THE ADULT HANDLES

Runs the blender and checks the set texture before serving.

Flavor & texture

Tropical, creamy, and naturally golden.

Allergens to check

Coconut; confirm the drink's full label. This version avoids dairy — verify all brands.

Age & texture

Let it set fully so chia is soft, not crunchy. Serve smooth and spoonable.



Learn together

Two-Milk Compare: try it once with coconut and once with dairy milk. Notice the taste difference.

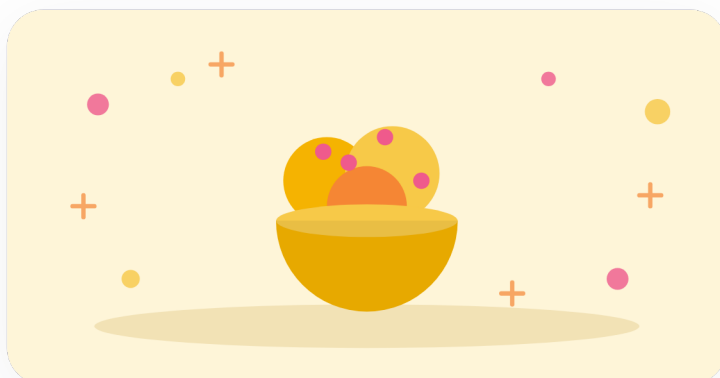
Try a swap: Use dairy milk if coconut is not preferred.

Test still needed: Confirm chia amount for a soft set and check the dairy-free flavour.



We made this!

One thing we noticed: _____



RECIPE 29 · YOGURT, PUDDING & CREAMY CUPS

DEVELOPMENT RECIPE — REQUIRES KITCHEN TESTING



Cocoa-Banana Smoothie Cups

🕒 **Estimated time** 8 min · **Estimated yield** about 3 small cups (estimated)

Do not publish or assign nutrition values before testing flavor, cooking, yield, allergens, and storage.

WHAT YOU NEED

- 2 ripe bananas (~220 g)
- 1 cup milk of choice (240 ml)
- 1 Tbsp unsweetened cocoa (~6 g)
- 1/2 cup plain yogurt (~120 g)
- 1/4 tsp vanilla (1 ml)

MAKE IT

- 01 Blend everything until smooth and frothy.
- 02 Pour into small cups and serve right away, or chill briefly.



THE CHILD CAN

Add the ingredients and press the blender button with an adult.



THE ADULT HANDLES

Supervises the blender and checks the texture.

Flavor & texture

Cool, creamy, and lightly chocolatey — like a thin milkshake.

Allergens to check

Milk depending on the drink and yogurt chosen.

Age & texture

Serve in small cups; thickness is easy to sip or spoon.



Learn together

Froth Watch: notice the bubbles on top. Where did the air come from?

Try a swap: Add a few frozen berries for a fruitier cup.

Test still needed: Test thickness, sweetness, and serving size.



We made this!

One thing we noticed: _____



RECIPE 30 · YOGURT, PUDDING & CREAMY CUPS

DEVELOPMENT RECIPE — REQUIRES KITCHEN TESTING



Vanilla Rice Pudding Cups

🕒 **Estimated time** 10 min + 25–30 min cooking · **Estimated yield** about 4 small cups (estimated)

Do not publish or assign nutrition values before testing flavor, cooking, yield, allergens, and storage.

WHAT YOU NEED

- 1/2 cup short-grain rice (~95 g)
- 2 cups milk of choice (480 ml)
- 1 tsp vanilla (5 ml)
- 1/2 tsp cinnamon (2.5 ml)
- 1 Tbsp honey*, optional (15 ml)

MAKE IT

- 01 Adult simmers the rice and milk gently, stirring often, until soft and creamy.
- 02 Stir in vanilla and cinnamon, cool to warm, and spoon into small cups.



THE CHILD CAN

Measure the rice and stir in the vanilla once cooled a little.



THE ADULT HANDLES

Manages the stove, stirs the hot pot, and cools it to a safe temperature.

Flavor & texture

Warm, soft, and comforting with gentle spice.

Allergens to check

Milk depending on the drink chosen. *Honey not for under 12 months.

Age & texture

Serve warm, not hot. Soft, spoonable texture suits many ages; adult confirms.



Learn together

Grow Watch: measure the rice before and picture it after. Why did it get bigger?

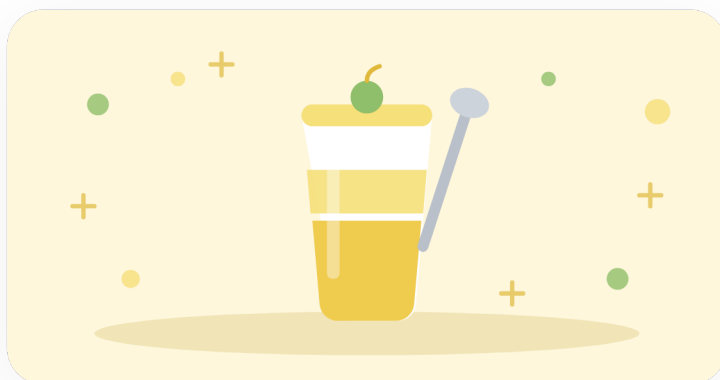
Try a swap: Use any familiar milk; oat milk makes it dairy-free (verify).

Test still needed: Confirm cook time, creaminess, and safe serving temperature.

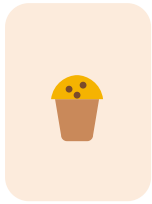


We made this!

One thing we noticed: _____



CHAPTER 7



Muffins, Bites & Small Bakes

Little bakes and no-bake bites — perfect for small hands and quick wins.

IN THIS CHAPTER

- | | | | |
|----|------------------------------|----|----------------------------------|
| 11 | Baked Banana Oat Bites | 14 | No-Bake Apple-Cinnamon Oat Bites |
| 12 | Carrot-Orange Mini Muffins | 15 | Pumpkin Spice Mini Muffins |
| 13 | Blueberry-Lemon Mini Muffins | | |



DEVELOPMENT RECIPE — REQUIRES KITCHEN TESTING

Every recipe here still requires kitchen testing.

RECIPE 11 · MUFFINS, BITES & SMALL BAKES

DEVELOPMENT RECIPE — REQUIRES KITCHEN TESTING



Baked Banana Oat Bites

🕒 **Estimated time** 10 min + 16–20 min baking · **Estimated yield** about 12 bites (estimated)

Do not publish or assign nutrition values before testing flavor, cooking, yield, allergens, and storage.

WHAT YOU NEED

- 2 ripe bananas (~220 g)
- 1 1/2 cups rolled oats (~135 g)
- 1 egg (1)
- 1/2 tsp cinnamon (2.5 ml)
- 1/2 tsp vanilla (2.5 ml)

MAKE IT

- 01 Heat oven to 350°F (175°C). Mash the banana and mix in everything else.
- 02 Drop spoonfuls onto a lined sheet and bake until the centers are fully cooked.

**THE CHILD CAN**

Mash the banana and stir the mixture with a spoon.

**THE ADULT HANDLES**

Handles the oven and pan and confirms the egg is fully cooked through.

Flavor & texture

Soft, warm, lightly spiced and gently sweet.

Allergens to check

Egg. Oats may have cross-contact with wheat.

Age & texture

Cool before serving; make sure centers are set. Recipes with egg must be fully cooked.

**Learn together**

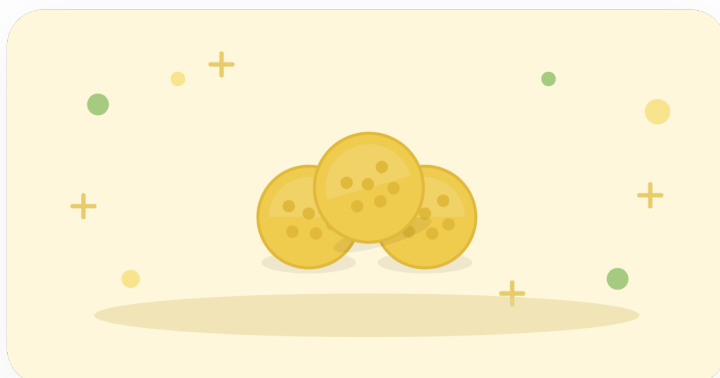
Before/After: draw one spoonful of batter and one baked bite. What changed with heat?

Try a swap: Add a spoon of unsweetened cocoa for a chocolate version.

Test still needed: Confirm bake time, bite size, cooled texture, and real yield.

☐ **We made this!**

One thing we noticed: _____



RECIPE 12 · MUFFINS, BITES & SMALL BAKES

DEVELOPMENT RECIPE — REQUIRES KITCHEN TESTING



Carrot-Orange Mini Muffins

🕒 **Estimated time** 15 min + 14–18 min baking · **Estimated yield** about 18 mini muffins (estimated)

Do not publish or assign nutrition values before testing flavor, cooking, yield, allergens, and storage.

WHAT YOU NEED

- 1 cup finely grated carrot (~110 g)
- 1 1/2 cups oat flour (~135 g)
- 2 eggs (2)
- 1 ripe banana (~110 g)
- 1/2 cup milk (120 ml)
- finely grated zest of 1 orange (1 orange)
- 1 tsp baking powder (5 ml)

MAKE IT

- 01 Heat oven to 350°F (175°C) and line a mini-muffin pan.
- 02 Mix the wet ingredients, fold in the dry, spoon into cups, and bake until the centers are cooked.

**THE CHILD CAN**

Mix the batter and place the liners in the pan.

**THE ADULT HANDLES**

Grates the carrot and zest, handles the oven, and confirms doneness.

Flavor & texture

Moist, fragrant, and sunny with orange aroma.

Allergens to check

Egg and milk; oats may have cross-contact with wheat.

Age & texture

Serve cooled; mini size suits small hands. Confirm centers are set.

**Learn together**

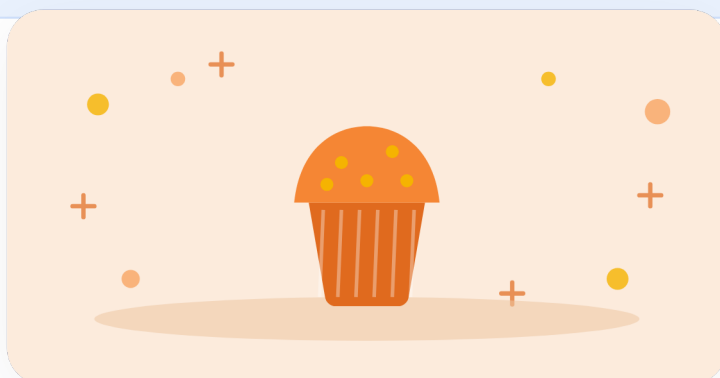
Aroma Hunt: smell the orange zest. Write three words for the smell before baking.

Try a swap: Use grated apple in place of carrot.

Test still needed: Adjust moisture, time, and yield for your specific pan.

**We made this!**

One thing we noticed: _____



RECIPE 13 · MUFFINS, BITES & SMALL BAKES
DEVELOPMENT RECIPE — REQUIRES KITCHEN TESTING


Blueberry-Lemon Mini Muffins

🕒 **Estimated time** 15 min + 14–18 min baking · **Estimated yield** about 18 mini muffins (estimated)

Do not publish or assign nutrition values before testing flavor, cooking, yield, allergens, and storage.

WHAT YOU NEED

- 1 1/2 cups oat flour (~135 g)
- 2 eggs (2)
- 1 ripe banana (~110 g)
- 1/3 cup milk (80 ml)
- 3/4 cup blueberries (~110 g)
- zest of 1 lemon (1 lemon)
- 1 tsp baking powder (5 ml)

MAKE IT

- 01 Heat oven to 350°F (175°C) and line a mini-muffin pan.
- 02 Mix wet, fold in dry and zest, gently stir in blueberries, and bake until set.

Flavor & texture

Bright, tender, and dotted with juicy berries.

Allergens to check

Egg and milk; oats may have cross-contact with wheat.

Age & texture

Serve cooled. Whole small berries in soft muffin are usually fine; adult judges for the child.


Learn together

Count the Berries: estimate berries per muffin, then break one open and count.

Try a swap: Use chopped strawberries instead of blueberries.

Test still needed: Confirm berry distribution, bake time, and cooled crumb.


THE CHILD CAN

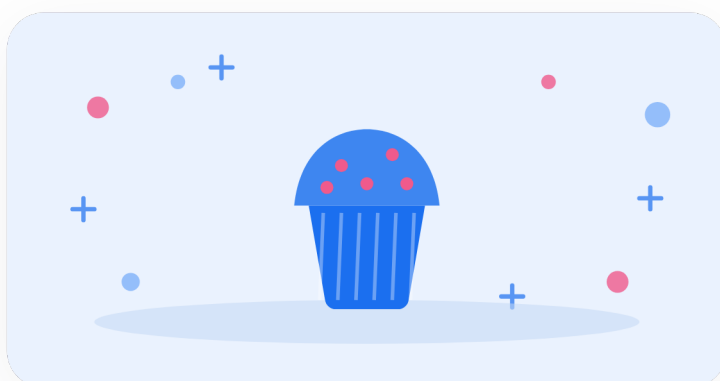
Fold in the blueberries gently so they do not squash.


THE ADULT HANDLES

Zests the lemon, handles the oven, and confirms doneness.


We made this!

One thing we noticed: _____



RECIPE 14 · MUFFINS, BITES & SMALL BAKES

DEVELOPMENT RECIPE — REQUIRES KITCHEN TESTING



No-Bake Apple-Cinnamon Oat Bites

⌚ **Estimated time** 15 min + 30 min chilling · **Estimated yield** about 14 bites (estimated)

Do not publish or assign nutrition values before testing flavor, cooking, yield, allergens, and storage.

WHAT YOU NEED

- 1 1/2 cups rolled oats (~135 g)
- 1/2 cup finely grated apple, squeezed dry (~60 g)
- 1/3 cup sunflower seed butter (~85 g)
- 2 Tbsp honey* (30 ml)
- 1/2 tsp cinnamon (2.5 ml)

MAKE IT

- 01 Mix everything into a soft dough that holds together when pressed.
- 02 Roll into small balls with clean hands and chill until firm.



THE CHILD CAN

Roll the dough into balls with clean hands.



THE ADULT HANDLES

Grates and squeezes the apple and checks the seed-butter label.

Flavor & texture

Chewy, apple-sweet, and warmly spiced — no oven needed.

Allergens to check

Seeds; oats may have cross-contact with wheat. Confirm all brands.

Age & texture

*Honey is not for children under 12 months. Roll to a safe, soft size.



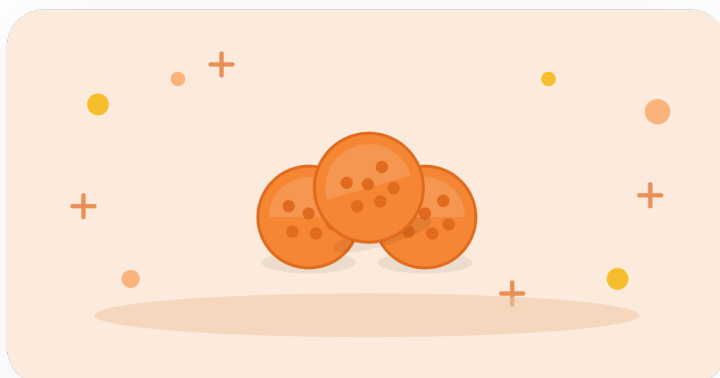
Learn together

Squeeze Science: notice how much liquid comes out of grated apple. Why do we remove it?

Try a swap: Swap seed butter for a smooth nut butter if there is no allergy concern.**Test still needed:** Confirm the dough holds, the size is safe, and the real yield.

We made this!

One thing we noticed: _____



RECIPE 15 · MUFFINS, BITES & SMALL BAKES

DEVELOPMENT RECIPE — REQUIRES KITCHEN TESTING



Pumpkin Spice Mini Muffins

🕒 **Estimated time** 15 min + 15–18 min baking · **Estimated yield** about 18 mini muffins (estimated)

Do not publish or assign nutrition values before testing flavor, cooking, yield, allergens, and storage.

WHAT YOU NEED

- 1 cup pumpkin puree (~245 g)
- 1 1/2 cups oat flour (~135 g)
- 2 eggs (2)
- 1 ripe banana (~110 g)
- 1 tsp cinnamon (5 ml)
- 1/4 tsp ginger (1 ml)
- 1 tsp baking powder (5 ml)

MAKE IT

- 01 Heat oven to 350°F (175°C) and line a mini-muffin pan.
- 02 Mix wet, fold in dry and spices, spoon into cups, and bake until the centers spring back.

**THE CHILD CAN**

Stir the spices in and smell the warm aroma.

**THE ADULT HANDLES**

Handles the oven and confirms centers are cooked.

Flavor & texture

Cozy, soft, and spiced like autumn.

Allergens to check

Egg; oats may have cross-contact with wheat.

Age & texture

Serve cooled; mini size for small hands.

**Learn together**

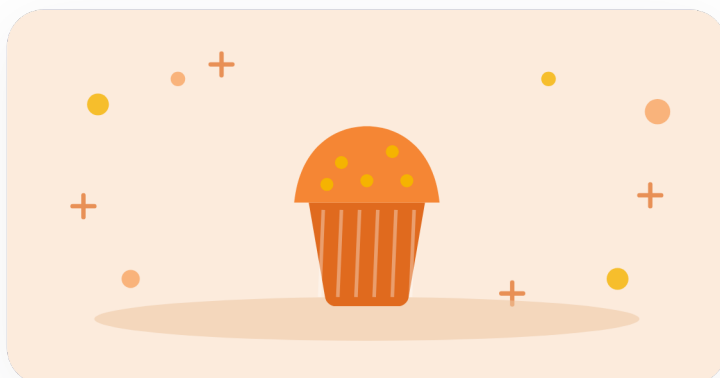
Spice Sniff: smell cinnamon and ginger separately. Which is warmer? Which is sharper?

Try a swap: Use mashed sweet potato in place of pumpkin.

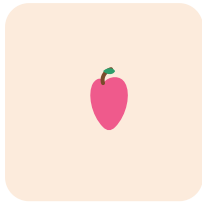
Test still needed: Adjust spice level, bake time, and yield for your pan.

**We made this!**

One thing we noticed: _____



CHAPTER 8



Warm Fruit Desserts

Fruit meets gentle heat. Soft, cozy, and fragrant with warm spice.

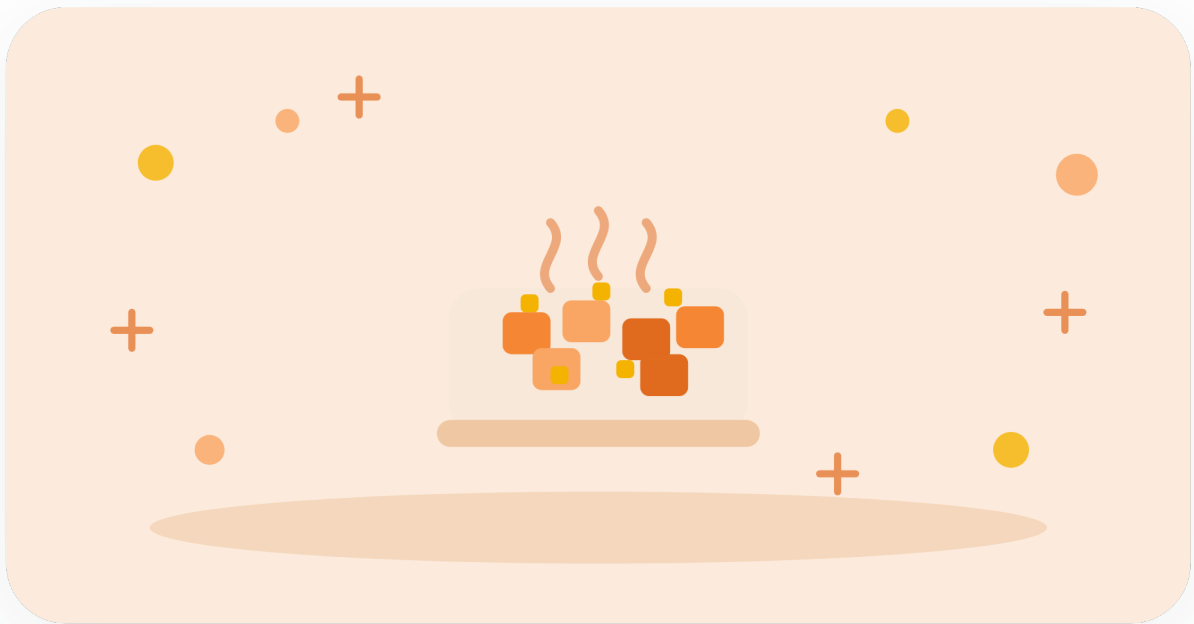
IN THIS CHAPTER

16 Warm Cinnamon Apples with Crumble

17 Individual Pear Oat Cakes

18 Baked Cinnamon Peaches

19 Warm Berry Oat Cobbler Cups



DEVELOPMENT RECIPE — REQUIRES KITCHEN TESTING

Every recipe here still requires kitchen testing.

RECIPE 16 · WARM FRUIT DESSERTS

DEVELOPMENT RECIPE — REQUIRES KITCHEN TESTING



Warm Cinnamon Apples with Crumble

🕒 **Estimated time** 12 min + 25–30 min baking · **Estimated yield** about 4 servings (estimated)

Do not publish or assign nutrition values before testing flavor, cooking, yield, allergens, and storage.

WHAT YOU NEED

- 3 apples, peeled if desired (~450 g)
- 1/2 cup rolled oats (~45 g)
- 2 Tbsp melted butter (~28 g)
- 1 tsp cinnamon (5 ml)
- 1 Tbsp brown sugar, optional (~12 g)

MAKE IT

- 01 Heat oven to 375°F (190°C). Cut the apples into small cubes.
- 02 Mix oats, butter, and cinnamon, spoon over the fruit, and bake until tender and golden.

**THE CHILD CAN**

Mix the crumble topping and smell the cinnamon.

**THE ADULT HANDLES**

Cuts the fruit, handles the oven, and checks that pieces are soft.

Flavor & texture

Warm, tender apple under a toasty oat crumble.

Allergens to check

Milk if butter is used; substitute only with a familiar, suitable option.

Age & texture

Cut apples small and bake until soft. Let cool from hot to warm before serving.

**Learn together**

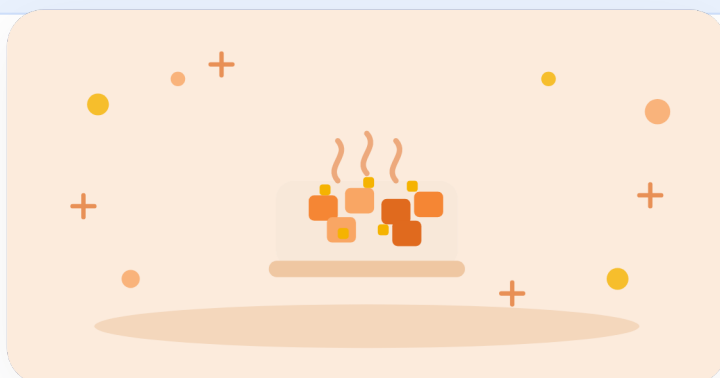
Hot vs. Warm: feel the bowl (adult helps). Why do we wait before tasting?

Try a swap: Use melted coconut oil instead of butter for a dairy-free topping to verify.

Test still needed: Validate cut size, tenderness, and topping-to-fruit ratio.

**We made this!**

One thing we noticed: _____



RECIPE 17 · WARM FRUIT DESSERTS

DEVELOPMENT RECIPE — REQUIRES KITCHEN TESTING



Individual Pear Oat Cakes

🕒 **Estimated time** 10 min + 18–22 min baking · **Estimated yield** about 2 small cakes (estimated)

Do not publish or assign nutrition values before testing flavor, cooking, yield, allergens, and storage.

WHAT YOU NEED

- 1 ripe pear, grated (~150 g)
- 1 egg (1)
- 2/3 cup rolled oats (~60 g)
- 1/4 cup milk (60 ml)
- 1/2 tsp cinnamon (2.5 ml)
- 1/2 tsp baking powder (2.5 ml)

MAKE IT

- 01 Heat oven to 350°F (175°C). Mix and divide between two greased ramekins.
- 02 Bake until the centers are set, then let cool until just warm.

**THE CHILD CAN**

Mix the batter and portion it with a spoon.

**THE ADULT HANDLES**

Grates the pear, handles the oven, and checks temperature before serving.

Flavor & texture

Soft, cozy, and gently sweet with warm pear.

Allergens to check

Egg and milk; oats may have cross-contact with wheat.

Age & texture

Cool from hot to warm; confirm centers are cooked. Egg recipes must be fully cooked.

**Learn together**

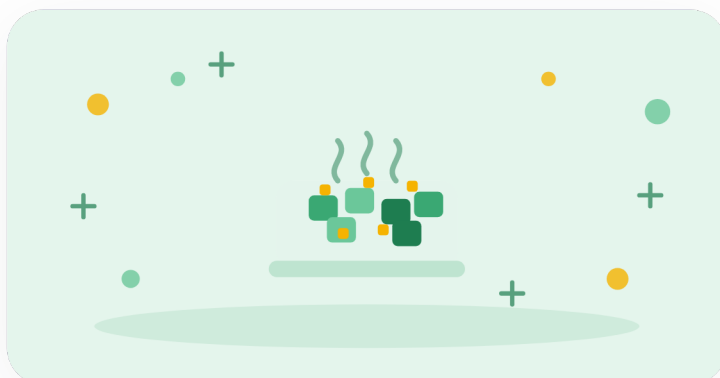
Portion Practice: try to split the batter evenly. Which cake looks bigger?

Try a swap: Use grated apple instead of pear.

Test still needed: Validate ramekin size, bake time, and interior texture.

**We made this!**

One thing we noticed: _____



RECIPE 18 · WARM FRUIT DESSERTS

DEVELOPMENT RECIPE — REQUIRES KITCHEN TESTING



Baked Cinnamon Peaches

🕒 **Estimated time** 10 min + 18–22 min baking · **Estimated yield** about 4 servings (estimated)

Do not publish or assign nutrition values before testing flavor, cooking, yield, allergens, and storage.

WHAT YOU NEED

- 4 ripe peaches, halved and pitted (~500 g)
- 1/4 cup rolled oats (~22 g)
- 1 tsp cinnamon (5 ml)
- 1 Tbsp melted butter (~14 g)
- 2 tsp honey*, optional (10 ml)

MAKE IT

- 01 Heat oven to 375°F (190°C). Place peach halves cut-side up in a dish.
- 02 Top with oats, cinnamon, and butter and bake until soft and fragrant.

**THE CHILD CAN**

Sprinkle the oats and cinnamon into each peach hollow.

**THE ADULT HANDLES**

Halves and pits the peaches and handles the oven.

Flavor & texture

Juicy, soft, and warmly spiced.

Allergens to check

Milk if butter is used. *Honey not for under 12 months.

Age & texture

Serve warm, not hot. Cut into small pieces suited to the child after baking.

**Learn together**

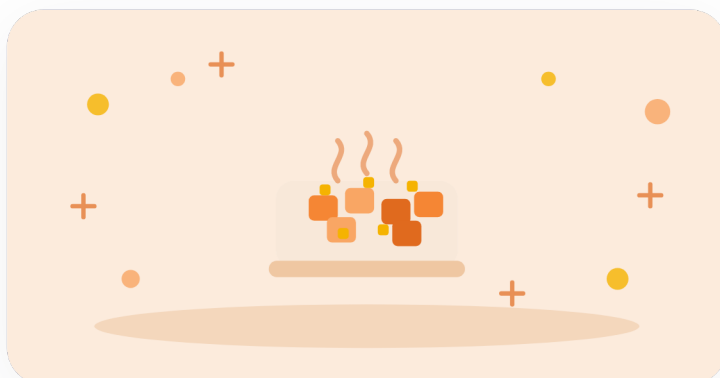
Juice Watch: look at the peach before and after baking. Where did the juice come from?

Try a swap: Use nectarines or plums instead of peaches.

Test still needed: Confirm bake time, softness, and topping amount.

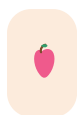
**We made this!**

One thing we noticed: _____



RECIPE 19 · WARM FRUIT DESSERTS

DEVELOPMENT RECIPE — REQUIRES KITCHEN TESTING



Warm Berry Oat Cobbler Cups

🕒 **Estimated time** 12 min + 20–25 min baking · **Estimated yield** about 4 small cups (estimated)

Do not publish or assign nutrition values before testing flavor, cooking, yield, allergens, and storage.

WHAT YOU NEED

- 2 cups mixed berries (~280 g)
- 3/4 cup rolled oats (~68 g)
- 2 Tbsp oat flour (~12 g)
- 2 Tbsp melted butter (~28 g)
- 1/2 tsp cinnamon (2.5 ml)

MAKE IT

- 01 Heat oven to 375°F (190°C). Divide berries among small oven-safe cups.
- 02 Mix oats, oat flour, butter, and cinnamon; spoon over the berries and bake until bubbling and golden.

**THE CHILD CAN**

Spoon the oat topping over the berries.

**THE ADULT HANDLES**

Handles the oven and hot cups and lets them cool to warm.

Flavor & texture

Jammy warm berries with a crisp oat lid.

Allergens to check

Milk if butter is used; oats may have cross-contact with wheat.

Age & texture

Berries get very hot — cool well before serving and check for any large pieces.

**Learn together**

Bubble Count: watch the berries bubble (through the oven door). What makes them bubble?

Try a swap: Use frozen berries; add a couple of extra minutes.

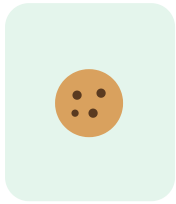
Test still needed: Confirm cup size, topping ratio, and safe serving temperature.

**We made this!**

One thing we noticed: _____



CHAPTER 9

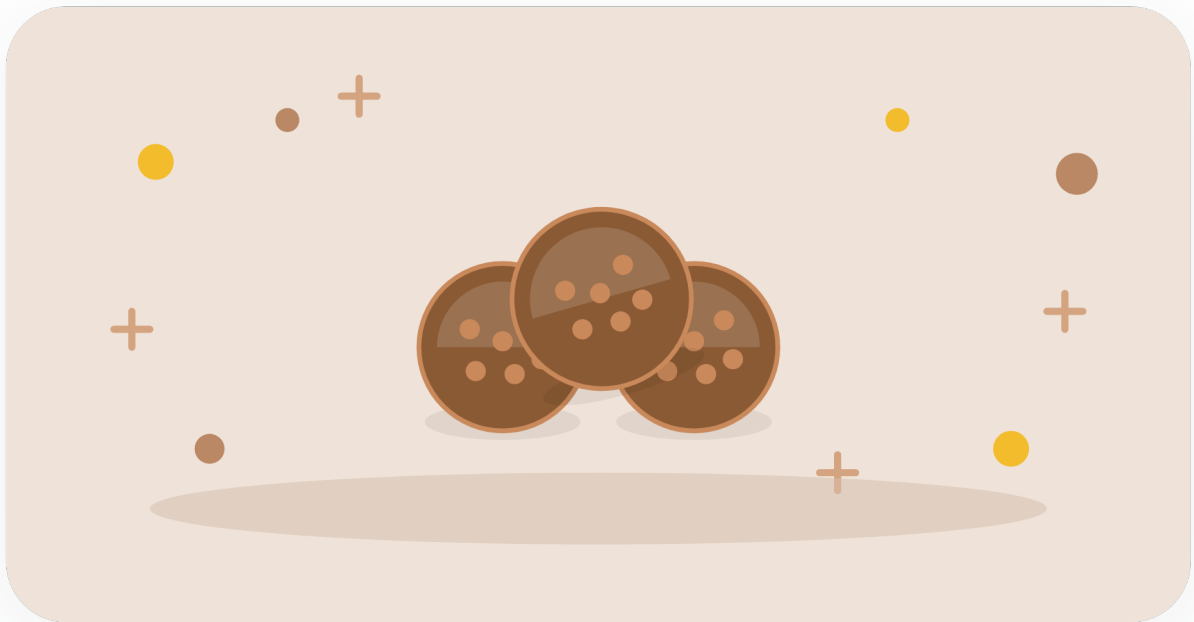


Cookies, Bars & Squares

Soft cookies, fudgy squares, and chewy bars built on oats and fruit.

IN THIS CHAPTER

- | | | | |
|--------------------|--|--------------------|---|
| 20 | Soft Pumpkin Oat Cookies | 24 | No-Bake Date-Oat Squares |
| 21 | Sweet-Potato Cocoa Squares | 25 | Soft Cocoa-Chip Oat Cookies |
| 22 | Soft Strawberry Oat Truffles | 31 | Berry Oat Crumble Bars |
| 23 | Banana Oat Breakfast Cookies | 32 | Oatmeal-Raisin Soft Cookies |



DEVELOPMENT RECIPE — REQUIRES KITCHEN TESTING

Every recipe here still requires kitchen testing.

RECIPE 20 · COOKIES, BARS & SQUARES

DEVELOPMENT RECIPE — REQUIRES KITCHEN TESTING



Soft Pumpkin Oat Cookies

🕒 **Estimated time** 12 min + 14–18 min baking · **Estimated yield** about 12 cookies (estimated)

Do not publish or assign nutrition values before testing flavor, cooking, yield, allergens, and storage.

WHAT YOU NEED

- 1 cup pumpkin puree (~245 g)
- 1 1/2 cups rolled oats (~135 g)
- 1 egg (1)
- 2 Tbsp sunflower seed butter (~32 g)
- 1 tsp cinnamon (5 ml)

MAKE IT

- 01 Heat oven to 350°F (175°C). Mix and rest 5 minutes.
- 02 Form small discs on a lined sheet and bake until cooked through.



THE CHILD CAN

Form discs with a spoon and the back of it.



THE ADULT HANDLES

Checks the seed-butter label, handles the oven, and confirms doneness.

Flavor & texture

Soft, cakey, and mildly spiced.

Allergens to check

Egg and seeds; check oats for cross-contact.

Age & texture

Cool before serving; confirm centers are set. Egg recipes must be fully cooked.



Learn together

Rest Test: notice the batter before and after resting 5 minutes. Did it thicken?

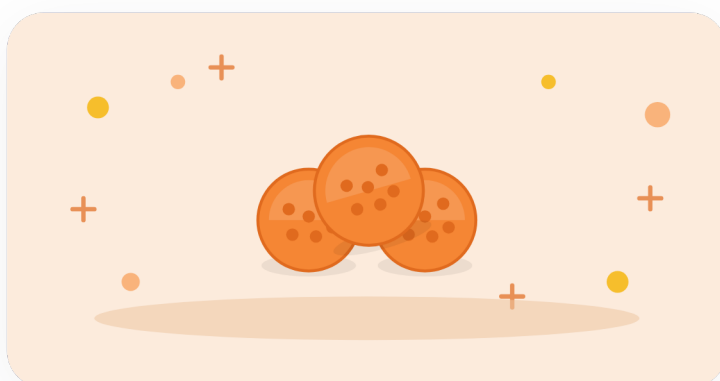
Try a swap: Use mashed sweet potato instead of pumpkin.

Test still needed: Confirm the cookies hold together and check moisture after cooling.



We made this!

One thing we noticed: _____



RECIPE 21 · COOKIES, BARS & SQUARES
DEVELOPMENT RECIPE — REQUIRES KITCHEN TESTING


Sweet-Potato Cocoa Squares

Estimated time 15 min + 20–26 min baking · **Estimated yield** about 12 squares (estimated)

Do not publish or assign nutrition values before testing flavor, cooking, yield, allergens, and storage.

WHAT YOU NEED

- 1 cup cooked mashed sweet potato (~250 g)
- 1/2 cup seed or nut butter (~130 g)
- 1 egg (1)
- 1/3 cup unsweetened cocoa (~30 g)
- 1 ripe banana (~110 g)
- 1/2 tsp baking powder (2.5 ml)

MAKE IT

- 01 Heat oven to 350°F (175°C) and line a small square pan.
- 02 Mix, spread, and bake until the center is set; cool before cutting.


THE CHILD CAN

Mash the sweet potato and stir in the cocoa.


THE ADULT HANDLES

Handles the oven and knife and verifies allergens and doneness.

Flavor & texture

Fudgy, rich, and deeply chocolatey.

Allergens to check

Egg; nut or seed depending on the butter chosen.

Age & texture

Cool fully before cutting into small squares. Confirm the center is cooked.


Learn together

Mix Colour: watch orange sweet potato turn brown with cocoa. Predict the final colour.

Try a swap: Use sunflower seed butter for a nut-free version to verify.

Test still needed: Confirm pan size, doneness, cutting, and cooled texture.


We made this!

One thing we noticed: _____



RECIPE 22 · COOKIES, BARS & SQUARES

DEVELOPMENT RECIPE — REQUIRES KITCHEN TESTING



Soft Strawberry Oat Truffles

🕒 **Estimated time** 15 min + 30 min chilling · **Estimated yield** about 12 balls (estimated)

Do not publish or assign nutrition values before testing flavor, cooking, yield, allergens, and storage.

WHAT YOU NEED

- 1 cup ground oats (~90 g)
- 3/4 cup crushed freeze-dried strawberries (~20 g)
- 1/2 cup sunflower seed butter (~130 g)
- 2–4 Tbsp milk, as needed (30–60 ml)
- 1/2 tsp vanilla (2.5 ml)

MAKE IT

- 01 Mix into a soft dough that holds its shape, adding milk a little at a time.
- 02 Roll into small balls with clean hands and chill before serving.

**THE CHILD CAN**

Roll the balls with clean hands.

**THE ADULT HANDLES**

Adjusts texture, checks labels, and decides the appropriate size.

Flavor & texture

Chewy, berry-bright, and lightly sweet.

Allergens to check

May contain milk, wheat, or seeds depending on brands.

Age & texture

Roll to a safe, soft size — not too firm or too large.

**Learn together**

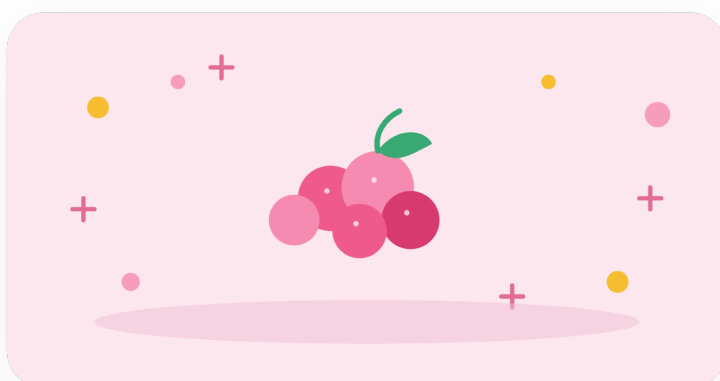
Sticky Scale: rate the dough from 1 (dry) to 5 (sticky). Add milk to reach a 3.

Try a swap: Use freeze-dried raspberries instead of strawberries.

Test still needed: Confirm cohesion, safe size, and actual yield.

☐ **We made this!**

One thing we noticed: _____



RECIPE 23 · COOKIES, BARS & SQUARES
DEVELOPMENT RECIPE — REQUIRES KITCHEN TESTING


Banana Oat Breakfast Cookies

Estimated time 10 min + 14–16 min baking · **Estimated yield** about 10 cookies (estimated)

Do not publish or assign nutrition values before testing flavor, cooking, yield, allergens, and storage.

WHAT YOU NEED

- 2 ripe bananas (~220 g)
- 1 1/2 cups rolled oats (~135 g)
- 2 Tbsp raisins, optional (~18 g)
- 1/2 tsp cinnamon (2.5 ml)
- 1/4 tsp vanilla (1 ml)

MAKE IT

- 01 Heat oven to 350°F (175°C). Mash bananas and mix in everything else.
- 02 Drop spoonfuls onto a lined sheet, flatten slightly, and bake until set.


THE CHILD CAN

Mash the bananas and stir in the oats.


THE ADULT HANDLES

Handles the oven and checks that they are set.

Flavor & texture

Chewy, wholesome, and naturally sweet — egg-free and dairy-free.

Allergens to check

Oats may have cross-contact with wheat. Raisins can be a choking risk for the very young.

Age & texture

For younger children, chop or omit raisins. Adult decides based on the child.


Learn together

Two-Ingredient Wonder: banana + oats makes a cookie. What holds it together?

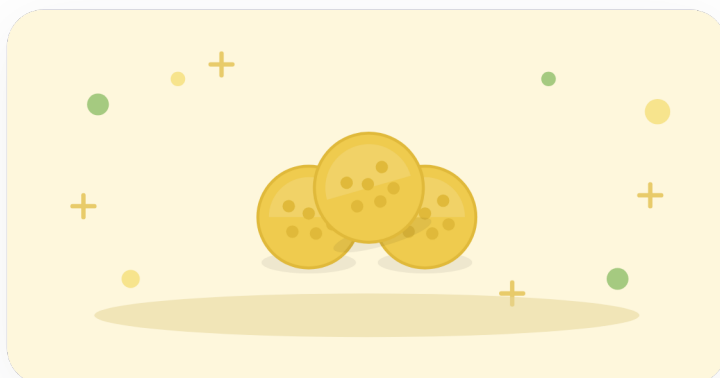
Try a swap: Swap raisins for chopped soft dried apricots.

Test still needed: Confirm they hold together, the bake time, and cooled chew.



We made this!

One thing we noticed: _____



RECIPE 24 · COOKIES, BARS & SQUARES
DEVELOPMENT RECIPE — REQUIRES KITCHEN TESTING


No-Bake Date-Oat Squares

Estimated time 15 min + 1 hour chilling · **Estimated yield** about 12 squares (estimated)

Do not publish or assign nutrition values before testing flavor, cooking, yield, allergens, and storage.

WHAT YOU NEED

- 1 cup soft pitted dates (~150 g)
- 1 1/2 cups rolled oats (~135 g)
- 1/3 cup sunflower seed butter (~85 g)
- 2 Tbsp milk of choice (30 ml)
- 1/2 tsp vanilla (2.5 ml)

MAKE IT

- 01 Blend the dates into a paste, then mix with oats, seed butter, milk, and vanilla.
- 02 Press firmly into a lined pan, chill until firm, and cut into small squares.


THE CHILD CAN

Press the mixture into the pan with clean hands or a spoon.


THE ADULT HANDLES

Blends the dates, checks labels, and cuts the squares.

Flavor & texture

Chewy, caramel-sweet from dates, no oven needed.

Allergens to check

Seeds; oats may have cross-contact with wheat.

Age & texture

Press firmly so squares hold. Cut small; dates are sticky — confirm easy chewing.


Learn together

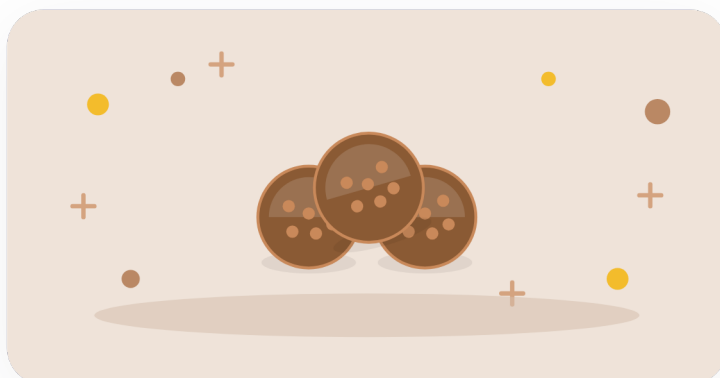
Paste Power: watch whole dates become smooth paste. What machine helped, and who runs it?

Try a swap: Use a smooth nut butter if there is no allergy concern.

Test still needed: Confirm the squares hold, the chew, and actual yield.


We made this!

One thing we noticed: _____



RECIPE 25 · COOKIES, BARS & SQUARES

DEVELOPMENT RECIPE — REQUIRES KITCHEN TESTING



Soft Cocoa-Chip Oat Cookies

🕒 **Estimated time** 12 min + 12–15 min baking · **Estimated yield** about 12 cookies (estimated)

Do not publish or assign nutrition values before testing flavor, cooking, yield, allergens, and storage.

WHAT YOU NEED

- 2 ripe bananas (~220 g)
- 1 1/2 cups rolled oats (~135 g)
- 2 Tbsp unsweetened cocoa (~12 g)
- 2 Tbsp chocolate chips (~24 g)
- 1/2 tsp vanilla (2.5 ml)

MAKE IT

- 01 Heat oven to 350°F (175°C). Mash bananas and mix in oats, cocoa, and vanilla.
- 02 Stir in the chips, form small cookies, and bake until set.

**THE CHILD CAN**

Count and stir in the chocolate chips.

**THE ADULT HANDLES**

Handles the oven and confirms doneness.

Flavor & texture

Soft, chocolatey, with little melty chips.

Allergens to check

Chips may contain milk and soy; oats may have cross-contact with wheat.

Age & texture

Cool slightly so melted chips are not too hot. Serve small cookies.

**Learn together**

Chip Count: give each cookie the same number of chips. Practice fair sharing.

Try a swap: Use raisins instead of chocolate chips.

Test still needed: Confirm chip amount, bake time, and cooled softness.

**We made this!**

One thing we noticed: _____



RECIPE 31 · COOKIES, BARS & SQUARES

DEVELOPMENT RECIPE — REQUIRES KITCHEN TESTING



Berry Oat Crumble Bars

🕒 **Estimated time** 15 min + 25–30 min baking · **Estimated yield** about 9 bars (estimated)

Do not publish or assign nutrition values before testing flavor, cooking, yield, allergens, and storage.

WHAT YOU NEED

- 2 cups rolled oats (~180 g)
- 1 cup oat flour (~90 g)
- 1/3 cup melted butter (~75 g)
- 1 ripe banana, mashed (~110 g)
- 1 1/2 cups berries (~210 g)
- 1/2 tsp cinnamon (2.5 ml)

MAKE IT

- 01 Heat oven to 350°F (175°C). Mix oats, oat flour, butter, banana, and cinnamon into a crumbly dough.
- 02 Press half in a lined pan, add berries, top with the rest, and bake until golden; cool before cutting.

**THE CHILD CAN**

Press the base and crumble the top layer over the berries.

**THE ADULT HANDLES**

Melts the butter, handles the oven and knife, and cools before cutting.

Flavor & texture

Buttery oat layers with a jammy berry middle.

Allergens to check

Milk; oats may have cross-contact with wheat.

Age & texture

Cool fully before cutting into small bars. Berry layer gets hot.

**Learn together**

Layer Count: how many layers can you see in a cut bar? Draw them.

Try a swap: Use melted coconut oil for a dairy-free version to verify.

Test still needed: Confirm pan size, set middle, clean cutting, and cooled texture.

**We made this!**

One thing we noticed: _____



RECIPE 32 · COOKIES, BARS & SQUARES

DEVELOPMENT RECIPE — REQUIRES KITCHEN TESTING



Oatmeal-Raisin Soft Cookies

🕒 **Estimated time** 12 min + 12–15 min baking · **Estimated yield** about 12 cookies (estimated)

Do not publish or assign nutrition values before testing flavor, cooking, yield, allergens, and storage.

WHAT YOU NEED

- 1 ripe banana (~110 g)
- 1 egg (1)
- 1 1/2 cups rolled oats (~135 g)
- 3 Tbsp raisins (~27 g)
- 1 tsp cinnamon (5 ml)
- 1/2 tsp vanilla (2.5 ml)

MAKE IT

- 01 Heat oven to 350°F (175°C). Mash the banana and mix in everything else.
- 02 Drop spoonfuls onto a lined sheet, flatten gently, and bake until set.



THE CHILD CAN

Count the raisins and stir the dough.



THE ADULT HANDLES

Handles the oven and confirms the egg is fully cooked.

Flavor & texture

Chewy, spiced, and studded with sweet raisins.

Allergens to check

Egg; oats may have cross-contact with wheat. Raisins can be a choking risk for the very young.

Age & texture

For younger children, chop or omit raisins. Cool before serving; egg must be fully cooked.



Learn together

Soak Test: soak a few raisins in warm water for 5 minutes. What changed?

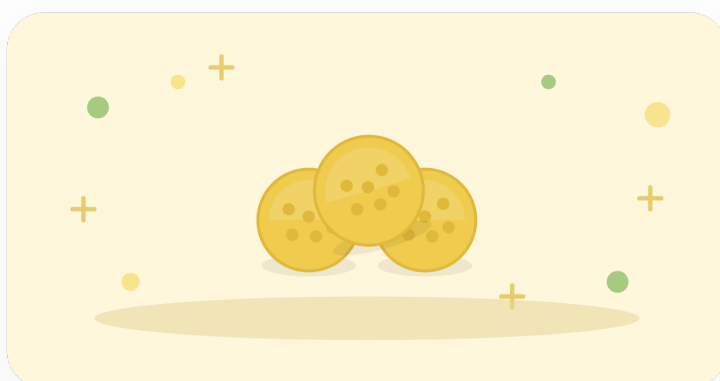
Try a swap: Swap raisins for chopped soft dried apricots.

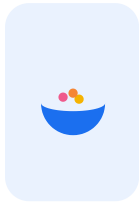
Test still needed: Confirm bake time, chew, and cooled texture.



We made this!

One thing we noticed: _____





Build-Your-Own Family Desserts

You are the recipe designer. Set up a station and let everyone build their own.

IN THIS CHAPTER

26 Build-Your-Own Yogurt Parfait Bar

28 Build-Your-Own Warm Fruit Bowl

27 Build-Your-Own Frozen Yogurt Bark



DEVELOPMENT RECIPE — REQUIRES KITCHEN TESTING

Every recipe here still requires kitchen testing.

RECIPE 26 · BUILD-YOUR-OWN FAMILY DESSERTS
DEVELOPMENT RECIPE — REQUIRES KITCHEN TESTING


Build-Your-Own Yogurt Parfait Bar

🕒 **Estimated time** 15 min set-up · **Estimated yield** varies — each person builds one cup

Do not publish or assign nutrition values before testing flavor, cooking, yield, allergens, and storage.

WHAT YOU NEED

- Base: plain yogurt (1 scoop per cup)
- Fruits: berries, chopped peach, banana coins (child's choice)
- Crunch: toasted oats, crushed oat cereal (1 spoon)
- Aroma: vanilla, cinnamon, orange zest (a pinch)

MAKE IT

- 01 Set out the bases, fruits, and crunch in small bowls with spoons.
- 02 Each person layers their own cup, choosing order and amounts.


THE CHILD CAN

Choose ingredients and build their own layered cup.


THE ADULT HANDLES

Chops fruit to safe sizes and sets up the station.

Flavor & texture

A different cup every time — you are the recipe designer.

Allergens to check

Milk; crunch toppings may contain wheat. Label each bowl.

Age & texture

Chop all fruit small. Adult supervises choices and sizes.


Learn together

Design Sheet: draw your parfait and give it a name in the Build-Your-Own pages.

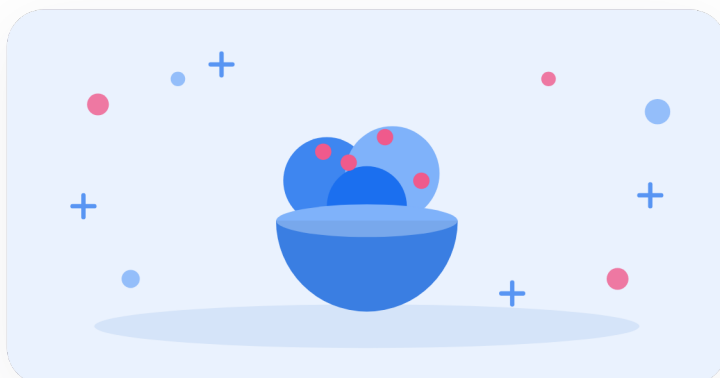
Try a swap: Use dairy-free yogurt for a non-dairy bar.

Test still needed: Note favourite combinations and which toppings stay crunchy.



We made this!

One thing we noticed: _____



RECIPE 27 · BUILD-YOUR-OWN FAMILY DESSERTS

DEVELOPMENT RECIPE — REQUIRES KITCHEN TESTING



Build-Your-Own Frozen Yogurt Bark

🕒 **Estimated time** 15 min + freezing · **Estimated yield** varies — one shared tray

Do not publish or assign nutrition values before testing flavor, cooking, yield, allergens, and storage.

WHAT YOU NEED

- Base: plain yogurt + 1/2 tsp vanilla (spread on tray)
- Toppings: halved berries, banana coins (child's choice)
- Crunch: crushed oat cereal (a sprinkle)
- Fun: a few chocolate chips (optional)

MAKE IT

- 01 Spread the vanilla yogurt on a lined tray.
- 02 Each person decorates their zone, then freeze and break into safe pieces.



THE CHILD CAN

Decorate their own zone of the tray with a pattern.



THE ADULT HANDLES

Halves fruit, manages the freezer, and breaks bark to size.

Flavor & texture

A frozen canvas you design and then taste.

Allergens to check

Milk; toppings may contain wheat or soy. Read labels.

Age & texture

Halve round fruit; break bark small. Let soften before biting.



Learn together

Zone Map: mark your zone on the tray and plan your pattern first.

Try a swap: Skip chips for a simpler bark.

Test still needed: Note topping amounts that freeze and bite well.



We made this!

One thing we noticed: _____



RECIPE 28 · BUILD-YOUR-OWN FAMILY DESSERTS
DEVELOPMENT RECIPE — REQUIRES KITCHEN TESTING


Build-Your-Own Warm Fruit Bowl

🕒 **Estimated time** 15 min + short bake · **Estimated yield** varies — one bowl each

Do not publish or assign nutrition values before testing flavor, cooking, yield, allergens, and storage.

WHAT YOU NEED

- Base: soft chopped apple, pear, or peach (1 scoop)
- Warmth: a little cinnamon (a pinch)
- Crunch: oat crumble (oats + a little butter) (1 spoon)
- Finish: a spoon of plain yogurt (optional)

MAKE IT

- 01 Each person fills a small oven-safe bowl with fruit and cinnamon.
- 02 Adult bakes until soft; cool to warm, then add crunch and a spoon of yogurt.


THE CHILD CAN

Choose the fruit and sprinkle the cinnamon.


THE ADULT HANDLES

Cuts fruit, handles the oven and hot bowls, and cools them to warm.

Flavor & texture

Cozy, soft fruit with a warm-spice smell.

Allergens to check

Milk if butter/yogurt used; oats may have cross-contact with wheat.

Age & texture

Fruit and bowls get hot — cool well before tasting. Cut fruit small.


Learn together

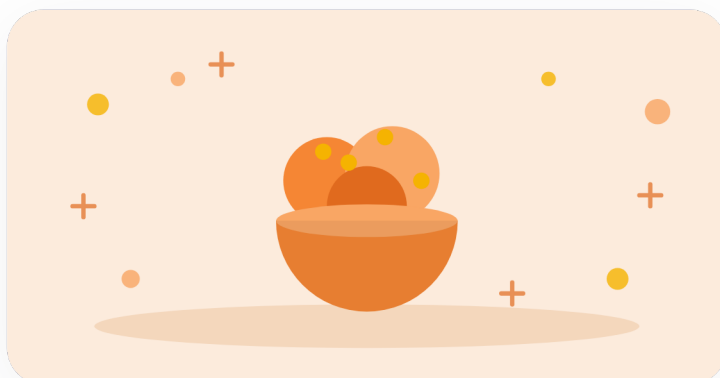
Warm-Word List: after tasting, write three warm words for how it felt and smelled.

Try a swap: Serve without baking as a fresh fruit bowl for a no-oven option.

Test still needed: Confirm fruit softness, safe temperature, and crumble amount.


We made this!

One thing we noticed: _____

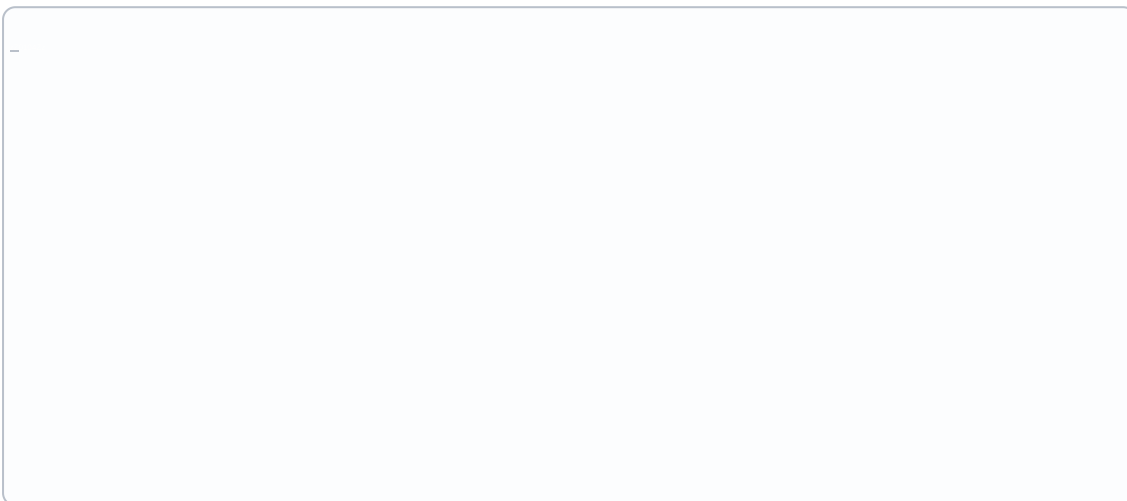


Design & Name Your Own Dessert

You have built parfaits, bark, and warm bowls. Now invent one that is entirely yours. Draw it, name it, and plan how the family would build it — one change at a time.

0 DRAW YOUR DESSERT

Sketch your creation in the frame. Add labels for each layer or part.



Name your creation

optional

Its best texture word

optional

Build-your-own plan

Base: _____ Fruit: _____

Crunch: _____ Aroma: _____

The one thing I would test first: _____

SECTION 11 · LEARN & PLAY

Flavor Lab

You do not have to love every flavor. The mission is to **notice**. A Flavor Lab scientist describes what they taste and feel — without calling it good or bad. Pick any dessert you made and investigate it here.

1 MISSION · FIVE WORDS

Which words describe your dessert? Tick all that fit — there is no wrong answer.

- ☐ Creamy ☐ Crunchy ☐ Soft ☐ Cold ☐ Warm ☐ Sweet ☐ Tart
- ☐ Smooth ☐ Juicy ☐ Chewy

2 MISSION · MY OPINION COUNTS

Finish each sentence in your own words. Remember: describe, do not judge.

The texture feels _____

The aroma reminds me of _____

Next time I would try _____

Scientist's reminder

Being able to say "I am done," "I want to try," or "I do not like that texture yet" is also part of learning. Your opinion counts, and it can change over time.

Flavor & Texture Wheels

A wheel helps you find the right word. Point to a slice, say it out loud, then decide if your dessert belongs there. Colour in the slices that match today's dessert.

3 MISSION · FLAVOR WHEEL

Which slice best matches your dessert's flavor? Circle it on the wheel, then write it below.



My dessert's main flavor is _____

A second flavor I notice is _____

It reminds me of _____

4 MISSION · TEXTURE WHEEL

Texture is how food feels. Tick every texture you can find in today's dessert.

- ☐ Creamy ☐ Crunchy ☐ Chewy ☐ Smooth ☐ Fluffy ☐ Icy ☐ Sticky
- ☐ Juicy

Aroma & Texture Vocabulary

Great cooks collect words. Here is a word bank — borrow from it, then add your own.

Aroma words (how it smells)

fresh · fruity · toasty · warm · sweet · citrusy · nutty ·
spiced · vanilla-like · cool

Texture words (how it feels)

creamy · crunchy · chewy · smooth · fluffy · icy · soft ·
juicy · sticky · silky

5 MISSION · SMELL FIRST

Before you taste, smell your dessert. Write three aroma words, then invent one brand-new word of your own.

Aroma word 1: _____ 2: _____ 3: _____

My invented word for this smell is _____ and it means



What do you notice?

Colour: _____ Sound when you bite: _____

Temperature: _____ One surprise: _____

One-Change-at-a-Time Lab

Real recipe testers change **one** thing, then taste and take notes. If you change five things at once, you never know which one mattered. Try it with any recipe.

6 MISSION · ONE CHANGE

Plan a tiny experiment. Change only one thing.

The recipe I am testing: _____

The **one** thing I will change: _____

What I think will happen (my guess): _____

What actually happened: _____

Did my guess match? ☐ Yes ☐ Not this time Next change to try:

Best-way-to-test check

If a recipe is too thick, what is the best next step?

☐ Change five things at once ☐ Change one thing and take notes ☐ Measure nothing

Answer in the Answer Key. Hint: scientists like to know exactly what made the difference.

SECTION 12 · LEARN & PLAY

Nutrition Explorer

Food gives your body **energy** to run, think, and play, and different foods bring different **building blocks**. None of this makes a food good or bad — it just helps us understand what food does.

Carbohydrates

A main **energy** source. Found in fruit, oats, and grains.

Fats

Give **lasting energy** and carry flavor. Found in seeds, nut butters, and dairy.

Proteins

Help the body **build and repair**. Found in yogurt, milk, eggs, and seeds.

7 MISSION · MATCH THE BUILDING BLOCK

Draw a line, or write the letter, matching each food to a block it brings. (Some foods bring more than one!)

Foods

A. Oats B. Yogurt C. Sunflower seed butter D. Banana

Blocks

_____ Carbohydrate
_____ Protein
_____ Fat

A calm truth

Your body is smart. It uses energy and building blocks from **all** kinds of foods. One dessert does not need to do a special job — it can simply taste good and be part of your day.

Different foods, different gifts

Each kind of food brings its own **flavors, colors, and textures**. Explore what each group adds — this is about curiosity, not rules.

Fruit

Sweetness, bright color, and juice. Think mango, berries, apple, pear.

Grains & oats

Chew, structure, and a toasty smell. Think oats and oat flour.

Dairy or alternatives

Creaminess and cool, smooth texture. Think yogurt and milk (dairy or plant).

Seeds

A little richness and gentle crunch. Think chia and sunflower seed butter.

8

MISSION · NOTICE THE GROUP

Pick one dessert you made. Which groups did it use, and what did each one add?

My dessert: _____

Groups I can spot: ☐ Fruit ☐ Grains ☐ Dairy/alt ☐ Seeds

The creamiest part came from _____ and the crunch came from _____

Hunger & fullness change

Some days you are hungrier than others — that is normal. Your body sends signals. Eating slowly helps you notice when you feel full. You are the expert on your own hunger.

Big ideas to grow with



Dessert is not earned

You do not have to finish vegetables or “be good” to have dessert. Dessert is simply part of family life — enjoyed, not traded.



One food is not the whole story

No single food makes a person healthy or unhealthy. What matters is **variety over time**, and that grows slowly.

Trying takes practice

It can take many friendly tries to warm up to a new flavor or texture. No pressure — curiosity does the work.

Enjoyment matters

Cooking and eating together builds connection. That is a real and valuable part of food, too.

9

MISSION · MY FOOD IDEAS

Finish these in your own words — there are no right answers.

A flavor I am curious about is _____

A texture I like right now is _____

Something I enjoy about cooking with my family is _____

This page teaches ideas, not medical advice. For questions about a child’s growth, diet, allergies, or health, talk with a pediatrician or a qualified nutrition professional.

SECTION 13 · LEARN & PLAY

Kitchen Games & Challenges

These games build the skills real cooks use — matching, sequencing, measuring, and spotting allergens. Play them any time. Adults: answers are in the Answer Key.

10 MISSION · INGREDIENT MATCH

Write the letter of the job each ingredient does in a recipe.

Ingredient

_____ Frozen mango
_____ Rolled oats
_____ Plain yogurt
_____ Ripe banana
_____ Cinnamon

Its job

- A. Adds creaminess
- B. Adds warm aroma
- C. Gives chew and structure
- D. Adds natural sweetness & helps bind
- E. Freezes into a cold, fruity base

Detective tip

Many ingredients do **more than one** job. Banana, for example, adds sweetness *and* helps hold a cookie together. Can you find another double-job ingredient in this book?

Put the Steps in Order

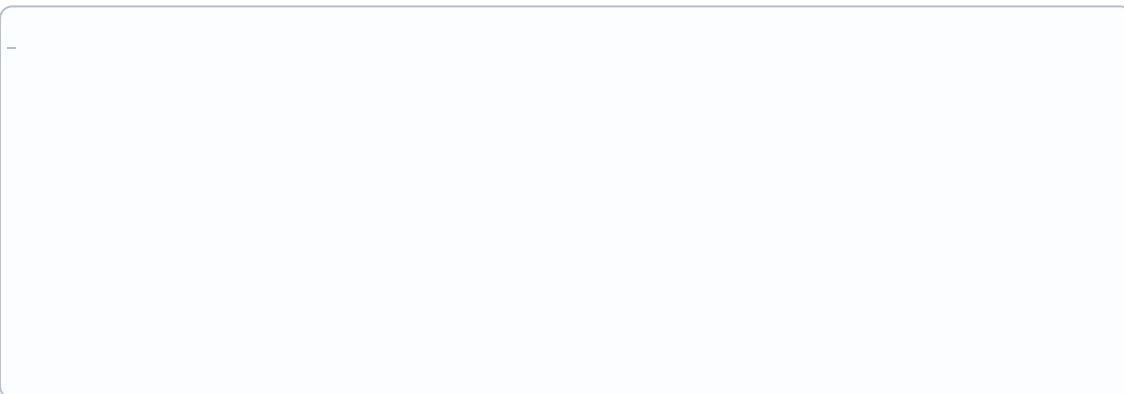
11 MISSION · MAGIC ORDER

These steps for Baked Banana Oat Bites are all mixed up. Number them 1 to 5.

- _____ Adult bakes until the centers are cooked
- _____ Wash our hands
- _____ Cool until just warm, then taste and notice
- _____ Mash the ripe bananas
- _____ Mix in the oats, egg, and cinnamon

0 QUICK DRAW

Draw the tool you would use to mix a batter without touching a blade.



The invisible field in the box lets a PDF reader mark it as a drawing area; on paper, just draw.

Measuring Challenge & Kitchen Math

Measuring is a superpower. Solve these with a grown-up. Write your answer on each line.

12 MISSION · KITCHEN MATH

1. A batch makes **8 pops**. If 2 friends share them equally, how many does each get? _____
2. You have **3 apples** and use **1**. How many are left? _____
3. A recipe needs **2 cups** of oats. Your scoop is **1/2 cup**. How many scoops? _____
4. Muffins bake for **16 minutes**. They have baked **10**. How many minutes are left? _____
5. You need **1 cup** yogurt but only have a **1/4-cup** measure. How many times do you fill it? _____



Measuring practice

Level: fill a 1-cup measure with water, then pour it into 1/2-cup measures. How many did it fill? _____

What did you notice about halves and wholes? _____

Spot the Allergen

Detectives read labels. For each ingredient, tick the allergen it **may** involve. Remember: brands differ, so the real label is always the final word.

13 MISSION · LABEL DETECTIVE

Plain yogurt — tick the allergen(s) it may involve:

☐ Milk ☐ Egg ☐ Wheat

Graham cracker crumbs — tick the allergen(s) it may involve:

☐ Milk ☐ Wheat ☐ Seeds

One egg — tick the allergen(s) it may involve:

☐ Egg ☐ Soy ☐ Milk

Sunflower seed butter — tick the allergen(s) it may involve:

☐ Seeds ☐ Milk ☐ Wheat

Chocolate chips — tick the allergen(s) it may involve:

☐ Milk ☐ Soy ☐ Egg

Why we check every label, every time

Why do we read every ingredient label?

- ☐ To check allergens and keep everyone safe ☐ Because the package is pretty
- ☐ To count the colors

Detective Challenge Board

Collect these skills over many cooking days — tick a square each time you do it. Fill a whole row to earn a Detective star. This is about **doing**, never about how much you eat.

☐

Name 3 textures

☐

Smell before tasting

☐

Measure 1 cup exactly

☐

Wash hands first

☐

Describe a color

☐

Find a double-job ingredient

☐

Spot one allergen

☐

Say a warm word

☐

Invent a dessert name

☐

Notice a change from heat

☐

Share fairly

☐

Try one new flavor

I completed a full row! Star earned:

☐

My favorite challenge was

SECTION 14 · TEST & CELEBRATE

Recipe Testing Journal

Every recipe in this book is a **draft**. This journal is where a family — or a test kitchen — turns drafts into dependable recipes. Use it the way professional recipe developers do: one change at a time, careful notes, honest decisions.

How to test well

- Weigh and record real brands and amounts.
- Change one variable, then taste and note.
- Write what you would change next time.
- Decide: approve, revise, or discard.

What we do not record

- Pressure to eat or finish.
- Guesses dressed up as facts.
- Calories or macros — those wait for verified weights and professional review.

0

FAMILY TASTE-TEST SCORECARD

Everyone scores the experience, kindly. Circle or tick — no one has to eat to take part.

Dessert tested: _____

Looks interesting:

☐ A little ☐ Some ☐ A lot

Smells inviting:

☐ A little ☐ Some ☐ A lot

Texture I noticed: _____

One kind word about it: _____

Kitchen Test Sheet #1

Complete one sheet per recipe and variation. Change one main variable at a time. This is a development record — nothing here is validated until review is complete.

Recipe & date	_____
Tester	_____
Brands & weights	_____
Actual yield	_____
Time & temp	_____
Texture hot / cooled	_____
Flavor: what worked	_____
What I would change	_____
Child response	_____
Allergens & subs	_____
Storage decision	_____

Decision: ☐ Approved for next round ☐ Revise ☐ Discard

Reminder: "Child response" records what you observed without pressure — not whether a plate was cleared.

Kitchen Test Sheet #2

Complete one sheet per recipe and variation. Change one main variable at a time. This is a development record — nothing here is validated until review is complete.

Recipe & date	_____
Tester	_____
Brands & weights	_____
Actual yield	_____
Time & temp	_____
Texture hot / cooled	_____
Flavor: what worked	_____
What I would change	_____
Child response	_____
Allergens & subs	_____
Storage decision	_____

Decision: ☐ Approved for next round ☐ Revise ☐ Discard

Reminder: "Child response" records what you observed without pressure — not whether a plate was cleared.

SECTION 15 • TEST & CELEBRATE

Dessert Detectives • Final Challenge

You have investigated flavor, texture, safety, and measuring. Time to put it together! An adult can read each question. Tick, number, or write your answers. Answers are in the Answer Key.

0 REVIEW • SAFE HANDS

Before we mix anything, what do we do first?

- ☐ Taste with a finger ☐ Wash our hands ☐ Turn on the oven alone

0 REVIEW • WHO DOES WHAT

Write CHILD or ADULT for each task.

_____ Measure oats _____ Use the sharp knife
_____ Mix with a spoon _____ Remove a hot pan

14 MISSION • DETECTIVE MASTER

What makes someone a great Dessert Detective? Tick all that are true.

- ☐ They notice flavor and texture ☐ They read every label ☐ They force others to finish food
☐ They change one thing and take notes ☐ They use kind, curious words

What I learned

The best dessert I made was _____

A new word I can use to describe food is _____

A kitchen skill I got better at is _____

Something I would like to invent next is _____

0 DETECTIVE REFLECTION

Finish the sentence — describe, do not judge.

Cooking with my family made me feel _____

You did it

You learned to cook with curiosity, stay safe, and describe what you notice. Those are skills you keep for life. Turn the page for your certificate.

SECTION 16 · FOR THE ADULT

Answer Key & Support Notes

Suggested answers

- **M7 Building blocks:** Oats → carbohydrate; Yogurt → protein; Seed butter → fat; Banana → carbohydrate.
- **M10 Ingredient match:** Mango=E, Oats=C, Yogurt=A, Banana=D, Cinnamon=B.
- **M11 Steps order:** 1 Wash hands · 2 Mash bananas · 3 Mix oats, egg, cinnamon · 4 Adult bakes · 5 Cool & taste.
- **M12 Kitchen math:** 1) 4 2) 2 3) 4 scoops 4) 6 minutes 5) 4 times.
- **M13 Spot the allergen:** Yogurt → Milk; Graham → Wheat; Egg → Egg; Seed butter → Seeds; Choc chips → Milk (often Soy).
- **Best way to test:** Change one thing and take notes.
- **Frozen pop change:** It melts.
- **Why read labels:** To check allergens and keep everyone safe.

Review answers

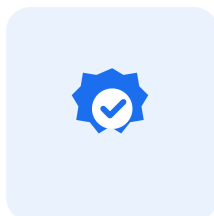
- **Safe Hands:** Wash our hands.
- **Who does what:** Child — measure oats, mix with a spoon. Adult — use the knife, remove a hot pan.
- **Detective Master (M14):** Notices flavor/texture · reads labels · changes one thing and takes notes · uses kind words. *Not* forcing others to finish food.
- **Wheels, vocabulary, drawings, reflections:** open responses — there is no single correct answer. Practicing the vocabulary is the goal.

How to support the child

Ask neutral, curious questions: “What do you notice? What might change if we chill it? Would you like to smell it before tasting?” Avoid bargaining over bites, praising a clean plate, or presenting dessert as a reward for eating something else. Let “I am done” and “not yet” be complete answers.

AWARD

Dessert Detective Certificate



This certifies that

(name)

has practiced cooking with curiosity, kitchen safety, and careful noticing.

Today I practiced: ☐ safety ☐ measuring ☐ describing ☐ testing one change

Date

Grown-up signature

MISSION COMPLETE

I learned to cook with curiosity, stay safe, and describe what I notice.

SECTION 17

Editorial Status, Safety Notes & Sources

Editorial status

A new, independent companion book — **not** part of the five canonical Body Recomp Bible volumes. This edition is a development prototype for choosing direction, testing recipes, and commissioning professional review. It is not final, tested, approved, or publication-ready.

Before publication, every recipe needs

- Kitchen & sensory testing
- Standardized ingredient weights
- Verified yield & storage validation
- Allergen & food-safety review
- Pediatric or qualified nutrition review
- Cristy Sim's final approval

Sources to consult during review

The four deep links below were carried forward from the development brief for verification. Broader references are listed by organization and document; a reviewer should confirm the current page and wording before any claim is published. No study, statistic, or recommendation in this draft should be treated as verified yet.

CDC — Choking Hazards (infant & toddler nutrition):

<https://www.cdc.gov/infant-toddler-nutrition/foods-and-drinks/choking-hazards.html>

CDC — Foods and Drinks to Limit:

<https://www.cdc.gov/infant-toddler-nutrition/foods-and-drinks/foods-and-drinks-to-limit.html>

FDA — Food Allergies:

<https://www.fda.gov/food/food-labeling-nutrition/food-allergies>

FoodSafety.gov — Cold Food Storage Charts:

<https://www.foodsafety.gov/food-safety-charts/cold-food-storage-charts>

Additional bodies to reference (confirm current pages during review):

- American Academy of Pediatrics / HealthyChildren.org — feeding, choking, and mealtime guidance.
- USDA MyPlate — food groups and family nutrition basics.
- Dietary Guidelines for Americans (USDA & HHS) — general dietary patterns.
- USDA / FoodSafety.gov — safe egg cooking and handling of perishables.

How claims were handled

What this book states

Only calm, observable, non-medical ideas: food gives energy and building blocks; frozen things melt when warm; wash hands before cooking; cook eggs fully; cut round or hard foods small. These are framed as general knowledge for a reviewer to confirm.

What this book avoids

No calories, macros, verified yields, or shelf-life. No claims that a food boosts immunity, burns fat, detoxifies, prevents disease, or changes behavior. No labeling foods good, bad, clean, or guilt-free. No hiding vegetables and no dessert-as-payment.

Next gate

Sensory testing of all recipes, standardized weights, verified yield, allergen controls, storage/shelf-life validation, pediatric or qualified nutrition review, and Cristy Sim's final approval. Until those are complete, this remains a development edition.



Safety, in one paragraph

Adults supervise young cooks and handle heat, knives, blenders, and allergens. Wash hands; cook eggs fully; keep perishables cold; serve foods at a safe temperature and size. Whole grapes, whole nuts, dense nut/seed butter, and hard pieces can be choking hazards — modify for the child. For any diagnosed allergy or swallowing concern, follow your healthcare professional's guidance. This book is for children about 5 and older; younger children and those with medical needs require individualized professional guidance.

The Family Dessert Kitchen · A Playful Guide to Cooking, Tasting & Learning Together · By Cristy Sim · Development Edition · All illustrations original.